SEPTEMBER 2026

FIRE PROTECTION

AUTONOMOUS FIRE PREVENTION SYSTEMS



Structural fires create new risks

- Risk management: Thatched roofs
- Firexpo 2026 report back
- Hazmat equipment for Overberg
- New Katlehong fire station

RAINBOW RESERVOIRS

Holding Africa's Water
30 Countries
and Counting





MINING

AGRICULTURE

INDUSTRY

FOOD & BEVERAGE

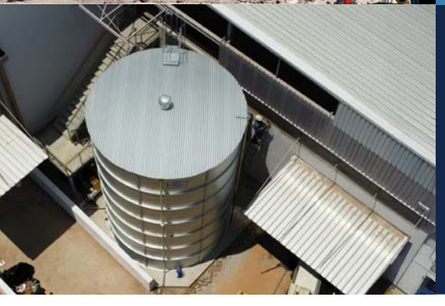
MUNICIPAL

FIRE FIGHTING



- High corrosion resistance
- Cost effective
- On-site assembly
- Tough and durable
- Low maintenance
- 5kL to 4000kL

- Steel-domed roofs or open-top tanks
- Human consumption/ food grade certified
- Tanks < 350kL require no concrete foundation



www.rainbowtanks.co.za

sales@rainbowres.com

+27 (0)11 965 6016

ASIB LISTED AND APPROVED SUPPLIER

South Africa

WISA Water Institute of Southern Africa

FIRE PROTECTION ASSOCIATION OF SOUTHERN AFRICA

CONTENTS

2 TRAINING FPASA fire-training courses and webinars on offer for 2026

3 VIEW The Editor's view on industry topics and this issue's contents

6 STRUCTURAL FIRES Structural fires deserve the same attention as wildfire management

12 AUTONOMOUS PREVENTION Industrial fire protection will be defined by autonomous systems

16 THATCHED ROOFS Hospitality industry is warned about thatched-roof insurance risks

20 EXTENSION CORDS Warning that cheap extension cords are driving fire risk in SA

23 FIRE EMISSIONS Experts study the toxic compounds released by home fires

26 TRADE SHOWS Firexpo 2026 was part of a broader industry conversation

29 MEMBERSHIP BENEFITS FPASA: The many benefits of belonging

32 LIBRARY Summaries of articles available from our Library

34 APPOINTMENTS Nelson Mandela Bay makes emergency services appointment

36 FIRE STATIONS City of Ekurhuleni opens the new Katlehong fire station

38 HAZMAT EQUIPMENT The capability of Overstrand Fire and Rescue has been boosted

40 FIREFIGHTING VEHICLES Knysna has acquired three new vehicles to strengthen its response

42 FIREFIGHTER FITNESS The fitness of leaders has a positive impact on firefighter team readiness

44 WILDFIRES: WEATHER How wildfires and their smoke can shape clouds, rainfall and lightning

48 FDIA MEMBERSHIP LISTING

FIRE PROTECTION

Vol 52 No 3 • September 2026
ISSN 0259 - 1766



COVER: As the built environment changes, our fire services must change with it

See page 6



Thatched Roofs

Thatched roofs are a growing insurance risk for the hospitality industry

See page 16

Publisher
Fire Protection Association of Southern Africa
Incorporated Association not for gain
Reg. No. 1973/000022/08

Editor
Mike Simpson
mike@media-simpson.com

Design and Production
De Roche Repro

Publisher's Address:
PO Box 15467 Impala Park 1472
Springbok Road Bartlett Boksburg
Telephone: (011) 397-1618
library@fpasa.co.za
www.fpasa.co.za

Advertising executive
Barbara Spence
Avenue Advertising
P O Box 71308
Bryanston 2021 South Africa
Tel: (011) 463-7940
barbara@avenue.co.za
www.avenue.co.za

Fire Protection is a magazine published quarterly by the FPASA.

The views expressed in articles by outside contributors are not necessarily those of the FPASA.
Permission must be obtained from the FPASA before material in this journal is reprinted or broadcast and acknowledgement must be given.

AUDIT BUREAU OF CIRCULATIONS

FPASA's fire protection training courses for 2026

The following are details of the FPASA's comprehensive range of courses on offer for 2026.

FPASA is committed to providing education. We have transitioned our theoretical courses to be conducted online. Get a discount when booking our online courses.

For all courses please refer to the training dates below. All courses are accredited by an appropriate body – such as the Local Government SETA (LGSETA) or CFPA Europe. Training takes place at the FPASA facility near OR Tambo International Airport in Boksburg, or arrangements can be made for on-site training at the client's premises.

FPASA members and stakeholders qualify for discounts of 5-30%.

Course dates and details as follows:

TITLE	OCT	NOV	DEC
1 Basic Fire-Fighting Module	07	03	02
2 Fire-Fighting & Evacuation	07	03	02
3 Hot work	13	24	
4 Team Building	02		04
5 SAQCC Assessment	27		
6 Sprinkler Pumps: Inspection and Testing		23-25	
7 Emergency Preparedness		23-25	
8 Workplace Fire-Fighting 1 & Breathing Apparatus and Grass Fire-Fighting } Optional add-on or standalone course		09-12	
9 Bylaws		16-19	
10 Fire Appliance Reconditioning	26-30	30-04	
11 Fire Risk Assessment & Prevention Strategies	05-09	30-04	
12 Advanced Fire Prevention		09-13 & 16-20	
13 Fundamentals of Fire Investigation	26-30		
14 CFPA Principles in Fire Safety Engineering	12-16		
15 CFPA Europe Fire Safety Diploma - Technical Cycle Exam (Diploma)		12	

Online courses in red

NOTE: 1. Courses can be arranged on-site on request - subject to a minimum number of delegates and suitable facilities.
2. The Association reserves the right to postpone or cancel a course.
3. These dates may be subject to change without notice. The amended course dates will be available on our website *www.fpasa.co.za*.

For more information, contact Christine van der Westhuizen on 011 397 1618. Or email her: compliance@fpasa.co.za



Webinars

Firewalls – 16 September

Major Hazard Installation Regulations – 18 November

For more information on seminars/webinars, contact Barbara on 011 397 1618. Or email her: barbara@fpasa.co.za

Bookings:
college@fpasa.co.za or
info@fpasa.co.za or
011 397 1618/19

Technical Enquiries:
compliance@fpasa.co.za

Library:
library@fpasa.co.za

Membership/Publication Enquiries:
reception@fpasa.co.za

Finance:
accounts@fpasa.co.za

Changes to the built environment bring many new challenges

Welcome to our third issue of *Fire Protection* for 2026. I trust it will be a smooth run-in as we head into the last few months of the year.

Once again, we have a bumper magazine that has been well supported by the industry in terms of advertising support and editorial ideas and contributions. We thank you for that!

As I write this from my office located just east of Johannesburg, the Highveld winter fire season has come to a close as we've experienced an unexpectedly wet spring. In the Cape, of course, our fire industry colleagues are getting ready for their notorious summer fire season.

Structural fires

Whatever the prevailing weather pattern, structural fires are a clear and present danger. Members of our FPASA team were on the ground in August for the Structural Firefighting Summit (see page 6), where speakers rightly pointed out that structural fires may receive less public attention than the growing wildfire threat, but they continue to impose an enormous human and economic cost on our communities.

Indeed, the changing built environment has created several new challenges for our fire services. Photovoltaic systems, battery energy storage, lithium-ion batteries and electric vehicles introduce new risks that firefighters must understand and be equipped to manage.

Lightweight construction materials can also affect how fires develop, while high-rise and increasingly complex buildings present challenges relating to access, evacuation, smoke movement and firefighter safety.

Please take time to read our coverage of this valuable inaugural summit.

Thatched-roof risks

Thatched-roof structures are, of course, a long-standing fire risk. Our article on pg 16 highlights the concerns of the short-term insurance industry around thatched-roof fire safety in the Southern African hospitality industry, in particular.

A combination of increasing fire losses, changing climate conditions and tighter global reinsurance markets has fundamentally altered how insurers assess thatched-roof properties. As a result, many hospitality businesses are experiencing significant premium increases, higher deductibles and stricter underwriting requirements.



If you have thatched-roof properties, or intend to, this is important reading.

Autonomous actions

You can't go far these days without coming across a discussion about artificial intelligence and modern technology in general. While there are clear and obvious concerns, there are many benefits for our industry too.

Fire-detection technologies, for example, are faster and more sophisticated. Smoke detectors have been complemented by flame detectors. Flame detectors have since been complemented by thermal imaging. AI is now improving the accuracy of thermal analytics even further.

The next step for industrial fire protection is not merely better detection; it's the ability to take immediate and appropriate action without human intervention. Read all about the solutions being delivered by Intelligent Autonomous Early Fire Prevention Systems on page 12.

So, as we enter the last few months of 2026, I wish you good luck and great success in your fire protection endeavours. Hang in there, year-end is not far off!

Enjoy your read, courtesy of the FPASA,

Mike Simpson
Editor



TECHNOSWITCH
FIRE DETECTION & SUPPRESSION

The BlazeCut company is a fire suppression system manufacturer and specialist that has changed the way a system can perform and protect against fire in harsh or high-risk environments.

BlazeCut offers the latest in automatic fire suppression technologies. The T-Series is an easy-to-install tube style device, developed for small to medium enclosed spaces and the C-Series is a cylinder style fire suppression system suitable for larger and complex applications.

BlazeCut T-Series

The BlazeCut T-Series system is a simple and cost-effective fire protection device for small enclosures.

When the temperature in the protected enclosure rises to a critical level, the detection tube melts at the point where the temperature effect is highest and releases the entire extinguishing agent stored in the tube directly onto the source of the fire.

The range is suited for compact electrical enclosures through to engine bays and large data enclosures.

BlazeCut C-Series

BlazeCut automatic fire suppression systems for indoor protection.

The BlazeCut® C-Series is a direct low-pressure (DLP) system that operates automatically and independently of any power supply – a key advantage because it functions effectively and suppresses fire even when the area is unoccupied.

With the addition of a pressure switch, the system can be monitored for leaks or activation by connection to a third-party fire detection control panel.

Typical applications include CNC machines, server racks, electrical cabinets, generator enclosures, telecom tower shelters, fume cabinets, ventilation devices, and elevator engines.

C-Series Features

Quick and Automatic Activation
BlazeTube is used as the detection and discharge line, once a set temperature is reached, the detection tube ruptures and creates a discharge nozzle. The extinguishing agent is automatically discharged into the risk area.

Easy to Install
Easy installation and maintenance.

Universal Use
The system design allows for a range of applications and will fit in almost any small enclosure space.

Independent power
The system does not require an external power supply to activate. This means that the system is always monitoring for heat without human intervention.

Cooling effect
The extinguishing agent's cooling effect on nearby surfaces reduces the likelihood of reignition.

Safe For People
The concentration of the agent is harmless to people and poses no threat to health once activated.

Fast Acting
The system has fast knock down design, which means the fire will be controlled before spreading.

Harmless
The gas system does not conduct electricity, corrode, or cause thermal shock damage and therefore there is no risk of harm or side effects to the protected enclosure.

Variety of Components
There are additional components that can be used on the system such as a pressure switch to monitor and shut down.

Larger Volumes
The system provides flexibility with the number of cylinders that are required to cover a space or multiple spaces.

Certifications

LPCB LOSS PREVENTION CERTIFICATION BOARD · CE · ISO

BLAZE CUT®

Head Office – Johannesburg
T +27 (0)11 794 9144
E info@technoswitch.co.za
Cussonia Park, 3 Ridge Road,
Laser Park, Johannesburg

Saving Lives and Assets since 1974

Structural fires deserve the same attention as wildfire management



The FPASA's Marius Atterbury at the Cape Town summit

Speaking at the Structural Firefighting Summit held in Cape Town in mid-August 2026, Anton Bredell, Western Cape MEC for Local Government, Environmental Affairs and Development Planning said structural fires deserved the same strategic attention, investment and innovation increasingly being applied to wildfire management.

"Structural fires may receive less public attention than large wildfires, but they continue to impose an enormous human and economic cost on our communities," he told delegates.

The Western Cape Disaster Management Centre hosted the summit in partnership with Santam and Fire Support Services SA. It brought together fire and emergency services stakeholders to share knowledge, strengthen skills and explore modern approaches to structural firefighting. Among the organisations represented was the FPASA.

South Africa's fire-related burn death rate is approximately 8.5 deaths per 100,000 people, while fires account for approximately 7% of injury-related deaths in the country. National estimates indicate that fire losses exceed R3-billion annually.



Research in the Western Cape recorded 1,370 fire-related deaths over a 13-year period, translating to more than 100 lives lost every year.

The MEC said the changing built environment was creating new challenges for fire services. Photovoltaic systems, battery energy storage, lithium-ion batteries and electric vehicles introduce new risks that firefighters must understand and be equipped to manage.

Lightweight construction materials can also affect how fires develop, while high-rise and increasingly complex buildings present challenges relating to access, evacuation, smoke movement and firefighter safety.

"As the built environment changes, our fire services must change with it. That includes legislation, training and the equipment we use," Bredell noted.

The MEC also stressed that firefighting must not focus only on responding to fires once they start, emphasising: "The best fire is the fire that never starts. Prevention must remain at the heart of our approach."

He said government, municipalities, the private sector, researchers, engineers, insurers and firefighters all have a role to play in identifying emerging risks and improving fire safety.

Bredell added that the Western Cape had already demonstrated the value of collaboration through its integrated approach to wildfire management, involving municipalities, fire protection associations, volunteers, ground teams and aerial resources.

The past wildfire season demonstrated the scale of the broader fire challenge. More than 215,000 hectares were affected by wildfire incidents across the Western Cape, while more than 76,000 hectares of Cape Nature-managed land were affected. The Cederberg Wilderness Area alone experienced its largest wildfire since 1997, with approximately 53,000 hectares burned.

A renewed approach to building resilience

Speaking at the inaugural summit, Dr Moses Khangale, Manager Stakeholder Programmes at short-term insurer Santam, reiterated that while historically less of a focus than veld or wildfire risk, structural fires are creating increasing risk to lives, property and economic stability as our built environment evolves.



MEC Anton Bredell speaking at the summit



A renewed approach to building fire resilience must be taken through stronger municipal capacity, skills development, risk mitigation and public-private partnerships, he stressed.

"Major incidents such as the Knysna fire of 2017, and the UCT/Table Mountain fire of April 2021 rightly saw an emphasis on veldfire risk in the recent past," said Khangale.

Until now, he noted, the sheer scale of wildfire risk has seen structural fires garner less public focus.

"According to our own research, fires remain one of the key drivers of commercial claims. But strategic alignment on modern structural firefighting practices is now critical because of evolving fire behaviour, modern building materials and increasing urban density," he told the gathering at the Lagoon Beach Hotel in Milnerton.

Central to the need for a renewed strategic approach to fire readiness are the shifts occurring in the built environment. Photovoltaic systems, battery energy storage, lithium-ion batteries and electric vehicles present emerging risks for firefighters.

In addition to this, Khangale said that rapid urbanisation also creates new considerations for fire risk preparedness.

"It is estimated that by 2035 more than 70% of the population will live in towns and cities. Concurrent to this, we will see an increasing focus on densification to maximise existing urban spaces via renewal, infill and multi-storey development. These trends go hand in hand with more widespread use of lightweight construction materials.

"All of these factors impact how a fire develops, its intensity and, critically, how it is addressed because of impacts on smoke movement, access, evacuation and firefighter safety," he said.

He explained that the added complexity has a real-time impact on how fires are currently dealt with on the ground.

"As the environment shifts, our responses need to adapt with it. And these changes filter into various aspects such as equipment, training and even legislation. This demands a centralised collaboration between private and public stakeholders," said Khangale.

An insurance viewpoint

From an insurance perspective, he believed that the sector played a critical role in building a resilient economy through protecting economic and productive infrastructure from fire



risk, stimulating the economy by transferring these insurable risks to the private sector, minimising the burden on the government fiscus, as well as providing expertise for increasingly complex fire-related risks, including for climate-induced disasters.

"Furthermore, insurers provide thought leadership and advocacy to help society adapt to emerging climate risks and can play a significant role in mobilising resources to build resilience and reduce disaster risks," he told delegates.

Kangale pointed to Santam's Partnership for Risk and Resilience (P4RR) as an example of the power of collaboration between government, fire services, academia





and the private sector to strengthen firefighting readiness.

"P4RR drives the implementation of risk mitigation and resilience-building initiatives in partnership with selected municipalities and other governmental agencies," he stated.

The programme has supported 110 municipalities since its inception in 2012, reaching over 180,000 people with targeted community-level disaster risk awareness and education, and having a downstream impact on 29.2-million people.

"To ensure the sustainability of the initiative, we have also trained more than 1,500 people in firefighting, safety, disaster management and related courses," Kangale said.

He added that early warnings are an integral part of disaster risk reduction, which require stakeholder focus as risks evolve.

"The Sendai Framework – a United Nations Disaster Risk Reduction framework – has a target to substantially increase the availability of, and access to, multi-hazard early warning systems and disaster risk information and assessments to people by 2030.

"To this end, Santam has supported the SA Weather Service to establish nine Automatic Weather Stations (AWS) across key provinces to maximise access to early warnings by vulnerable communities. These AWS have been integrated into [the] SAWS weather observation system network and are providing critical weather data."

Kangale concluded by saying collaborative efforts reduce the risk protection gap and enhance the capacity and capabilities of beneficiary municipalities to effectively manage disaster risks in their areas of jurisdiction.

"Building resilience is a shared responsibility that requires an 'all of society approach'. By fostering collaboration and knowledge-sharing, we can address skills gaps in structural firefighting operations and contribute to the reduction of fire damage, and critically, the protection of our people and communities," he emphasised to delegates.

Photo credits: Western Cape Government/FPASA



The next generation of industrial fire protection systems



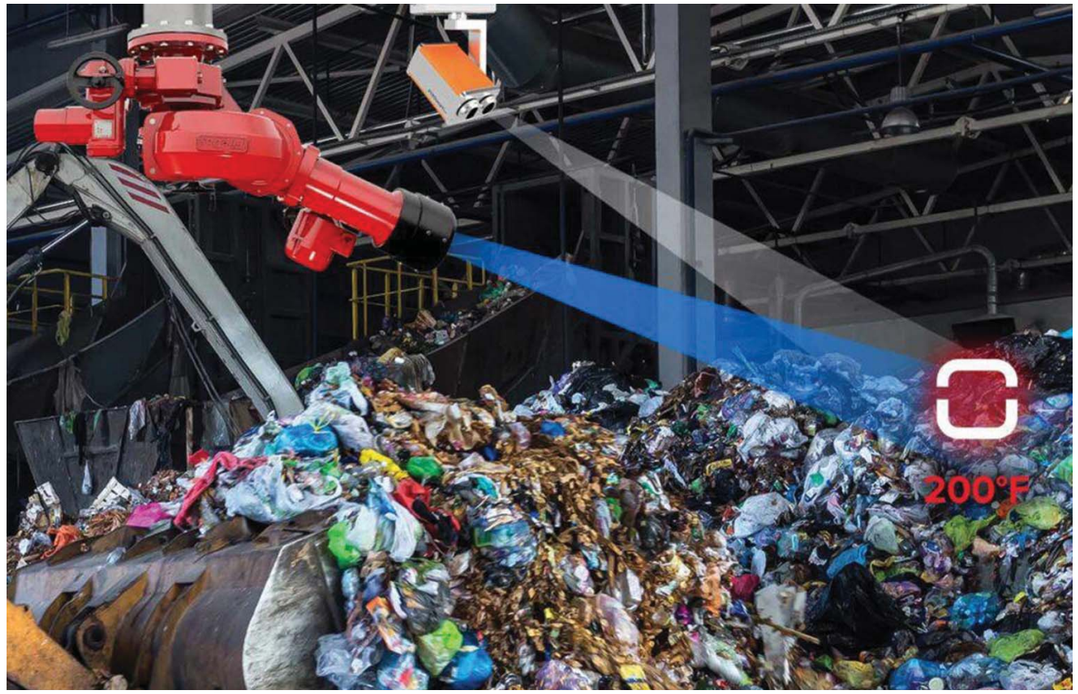
Article supplied by FireDos GmbH of Germany, via DoseTech Fire, South Africa.

Industrial fire protection has always evolved in response to changing risks. As industrial processes became more complex, detection technologies became faster and more sophisticated.

Smoke detectors were complemented by flame detectors. Flame detectors were complemented by thermal imaging. Artificial intelligence is now improving the accuracy of thermal analytics even further.

These developments have significantly reduced detection times and undoubtedly prevented countless major fires. However, they also reveal an important reality: Detection alone does not stop a fire.

Once an abnormal thermal event has been identified, every second that passes before suppression begins allows the incident to develop further. In high-risk industries such as waste recycling, paper production, biomass processing,



battery energy storage, logistics and alternative fuels, those seconds can determine whether an isolated hotspot becomes a catastrophic fire.

The next generation of industrial fire protection will therefore no longer be defined solely by better detection. It will be defined by Autonomous Early Fire Prevention Systems.

A shift in engineering philosophy

For decades, industrial fire protection has focused on improving individual components:

- Higher-resolution cameras.
- Smarter analytics.
- Faster communication.
- More accurate fire monitors.

Each innovation has delivered measurable improvements. Yet these technologies have often remained separate engineering disciplines, connected only through conventional control systems and human decision-making.

The next technological leap is fundamentally different. Instead of optimising individual products, the industry is beginning to integrate detection, intelligence and suppression into one coordinated protection architecture.

This is more than another product innovation. It represents a new engineering philosophy.

From detection to prevention

Traditional fire protection answers one question: How quickly can a fire be detected?

Autonomous Early Fire Prevention Systems ask a different question: How quickly can fire growth be prevented?

The distinction is subtle, but significant. Detection identifies a developing hazard. Prevention actively interrupts its development before it becomes a major incident.

This shift reflects the broader direction of industrial automation, where modern production facilities no longer rely on operators to manually adjust every process parameter.

Warehouse systems move autonomously and manufacturing lines optimise themselves continuously. Complex industrial processes increasingly combine advanced sensing with intelligent decision-making and automated execution.

Industrial fire protection is following the same evolution.

The last remaining bottleneck

Today's thermal-detection technology has reached an impressive level of maturity – one where artificial intelligence can identify abnormal thermal behaviour with remarkable precision. Communication networks transmit

information almost instantaneously and fire monitors achieve exceptional positioning accuracy.

Ironically, the remaining variable is often no longer technological. It is the unavoidable delay between detection and suppression. In many existing protection concepts, an alarm is generated, evaluated by an operator, and then manually confirmed before extinguishment begins.

This operational philosophy has served industry well for many years. However, as fire risks continue to evolve, operators are increasingly asking whether time-critical suppression should always depend on manual intervention.

For rapidly developing fires involving lithium-ion batteries, shredded waste, plastics or paper stock, even one additional minute may significantly influence the scale of property damage and business interruption.

Reducing the time between detection and suppression is therefore becoming one of the industry's most important engineering objectives.

Engineering convergence

Perhaps the most significant development is the convergence of two engineering disciplines that have traditionally evolved independently.

The first discipline is thermal intelligence. It combines infrared sensing, advanced analytics, artificial intelligence, hotspot localisation and continuous risk assessment to understand what is happening inside a protected facility.

The second discipline is fire suppression engineering. It encompasses monitor technology, hydraulic performance, suppression media, precision positioning and reliable system actuation.

Historically, these disciplines have often been viewed as separate systems. Tomorrow, they will increasingly function as one.

This convergence will define the performance of Autonomous Early Fire Prevention Systems. Success will no longer depend on selecting the best camera or the best fire monitor individually. Rather, it will depend on how intelligently both engineering platforms operate together.

Beyond individual components

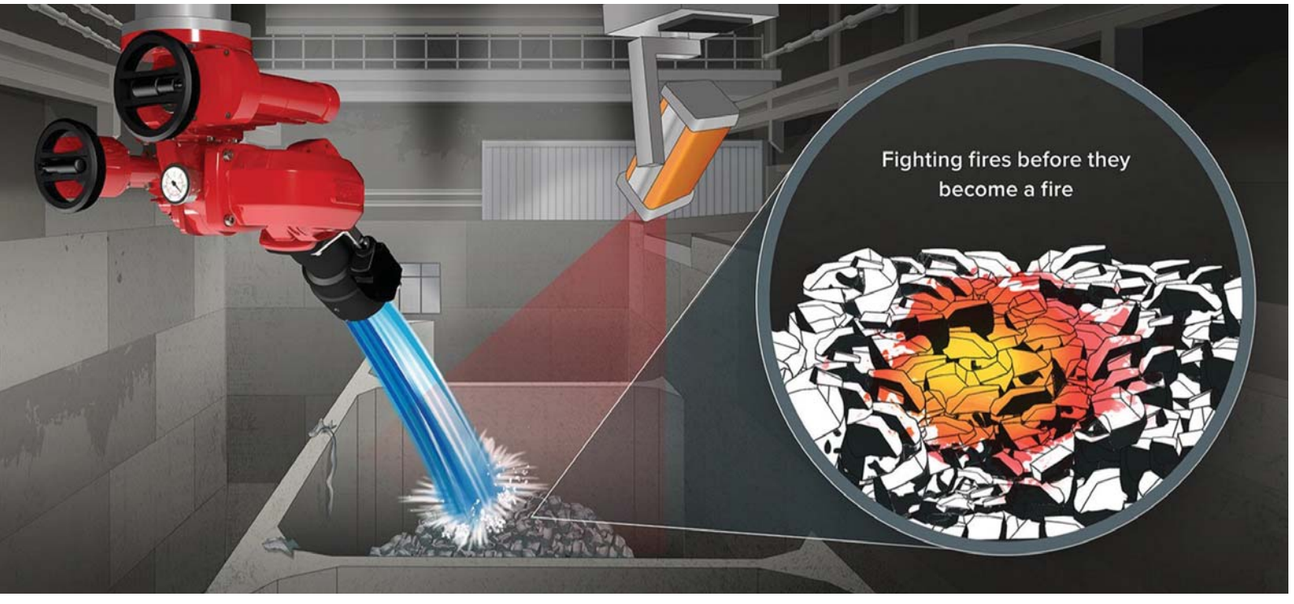
Industrial users are increasingly evaluating complete protection architectures rather than individual products.

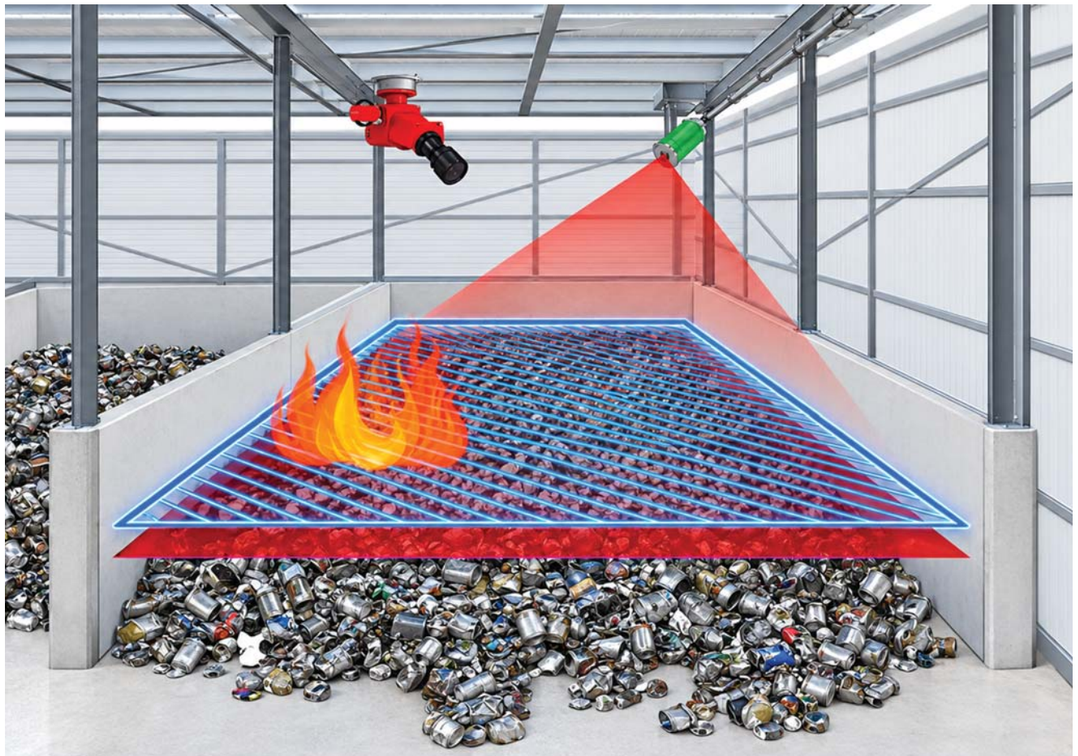
The conversation is changing. Instead of asking "Which thermal camera should we install?" or "Which fire monitor offers the highest performance?", owners and consulting engineers are beginning to ask "How well does the entire protection system work as one integrated solution?"

This represents a fundamental change in purchasing philosophy. System intelligence is becoming just as important as component performance.

The road ahead

Independent certification will continue to play a critical role in industrial fire protection. Equally important, however, is the continued evolution of integrated system architectures capable of responding more quickly, more consistently and with fewer opportunities for delay.





Autonomous Early Fire Prevention Systems should therefore not be viewed as a replacement for established fire protection principles. Rather, they represent their logical evolution.

As industrial facilities become increasingly automated, fire protection will inevitably follow the same path.

A new benchmark for industrial fire protection

The history of engineering demonstrates that technological progress rarely occurs through isolated innovation. It occurs when previously independent technologies converge into a new system architecture.

Industrial fire protection has reached exactly this point. The defining question for the coming decade is no longer "How quickly can we detect a fire?" Instead, it is "How quickly can we prevent it from becoming one?"

Autonomous Early Fire Prevention Systems provide one possible answer to that question by combining thermal intelligence and precision fire suppression into one integrated engineering concept.

Several companies have already begun translating this philosophy into practical industrial solutions. One example is ACEDES, which combines advanced thermal intelligence with precision fire suppression engineering to create an integrated Autonomous Early Fire Prevention System for high-risk industrial applications.

ACEDES stands for Autonomous Coupled Early Detection and Extinguishing System. It is a highly specialised industrial safety solution formed through the joint venture of FireDos and Orglmeister Infrared Systems. The system is built specifically to address high-risk industrial environments where traditional smoke and flame detectors are too slow or prone to failure.

Whether the final system architectures differ from manufacturer to manufacturer is ultimately secondary.

The industry's direction is becoming increasingly clear. The future of industrial fire protection lies beyond detection. It lies in intelligent, autonomous prevention.

DoseTech (Pty) Ltd, trading as DoseTech Fire, is a South African specialist fire protection company that provides foam dosing technology and high-risk firefighting hardware.

Photo & illustration credits: Simpson Media/ChatGPT AI; FireDos GmbH

Hospitality industry must revise approach to risk, insurer warns



For decades, the iconic thatch roof has been synonymous with South Africa's hospitality industry. From luxury safari lodges and bush retreats to country guesthouses and entertainment lapas, thatch has become part of the authentic African experience that both local and international travellers have come to expect.

Today, however, that same architectural feature is becoming one of the hospitality sector's greatest insurance challenges, insurance company Aon South Africa warns.

The insurer says a combination of increasing fire losses, changing climate conditions and tighter global reinsurance markets has fundamentally altered how insurers assess thatch roofed properties.

As a result, many hospitality businesses are experiencing significant premium increases, higher deductibles and stricter underwriting requirements.

"Over the last few years, we've seen a pronounced tightening in appetite for hospitality thatch risks," says Cecil Madziwa, Commercial Client Manager at Aon South Africa.

"Several insurers have reduced their capacity or withdrawn from this segment entirely. That leaves fewer markets competing for these risks, which has pushed premiums up and, in some cases, led to very challenging renewal terms."

Changing risk landscape

While thatch has always carried a higher fire risk, the operating environment has changed significantly over the past decade. More severe droughts, longer dry seasons and frequent veld fires, intensified by climate change, have increased the likelihood and severity of fires spreading to hospitality properties.

Insurers have also recorded major fire losses at thatch-roofed properties, including lightning-related incidents at high-end lodges.

"Even when buildings are not destroyed, the financial impact often extends well beyond structural repairs. Business interruption, guest relocations, cancellations, reputational damage and specialist rebuilding costs can far exceed the initial fire damage," Madziwa explains.

These trends also affect global reinsurers, which provide much of the capacity behind local insurance markets. Their caution has reduced underwriting capacity and contributed to higher premiums.

In practice, this means that insurers now assess the property as a whole, rather than each structure separately. As a result, even one lapa, entertainment area or outbuilding with a thatch, reed or tile-over thatch roof can affect how the entire risk is priced.

Factors commonly assessed include:

- The distance between thatched buildings and neighbouring structures.
- The amount of surrounding





vegetation and proximity to open veld.

- The proportion of the property's total roof area that consists of thatch.
- Existing fire prevention, detection and suppression systems.
- Lightning protection measures and overall site maintenance.

Risk management is now the difference

Insurance based on the appearance and occupancy of a property are rapidly being replaced by insurers expecting businesses to demonstrate proactive risk management before offering favourable terms.

"Measures such as well-maintained fire breaks, vegetation management, compliant lightning protection systems and comprehensive emergency response planning have become increasingly important. Larger hospitality operations may also be expected to install dedicated fire water storage, sprinkler systems or fixed suppression systems," Madziwa states.

These investments, however, come at a considerable cost to the hospitality sector as it continues to recover from the financial impact of Covid and ongoing economic pressures.

"It creates difficult commercial decisions between investing in additional protection, accepting higher insurance costs or retaining more risk within the business," says Madziwa.



Alternative risk solutions

As traditional insurance becomes more restrictive, many hospitality operators are beginning to explore different approaches to managing their risk.

"Some are investigating fibre thatch and alternative roofing systems that retain the visual appeal of traditional thatch while potentially improving fire performance. However, insurers remain cautious until sufficient local performance data and independent combustibility testing becomes available for specific products and installation methods," notes Madziwa.

Others are considering alternative approaches to financing risk. Higher deductibles, self-insurance and alternative risk-financing structures are increasingly becoming part of discussions for larger hospitality businesses seeking greater flexibility as insurance market conditions evolve.



Long-term insurability

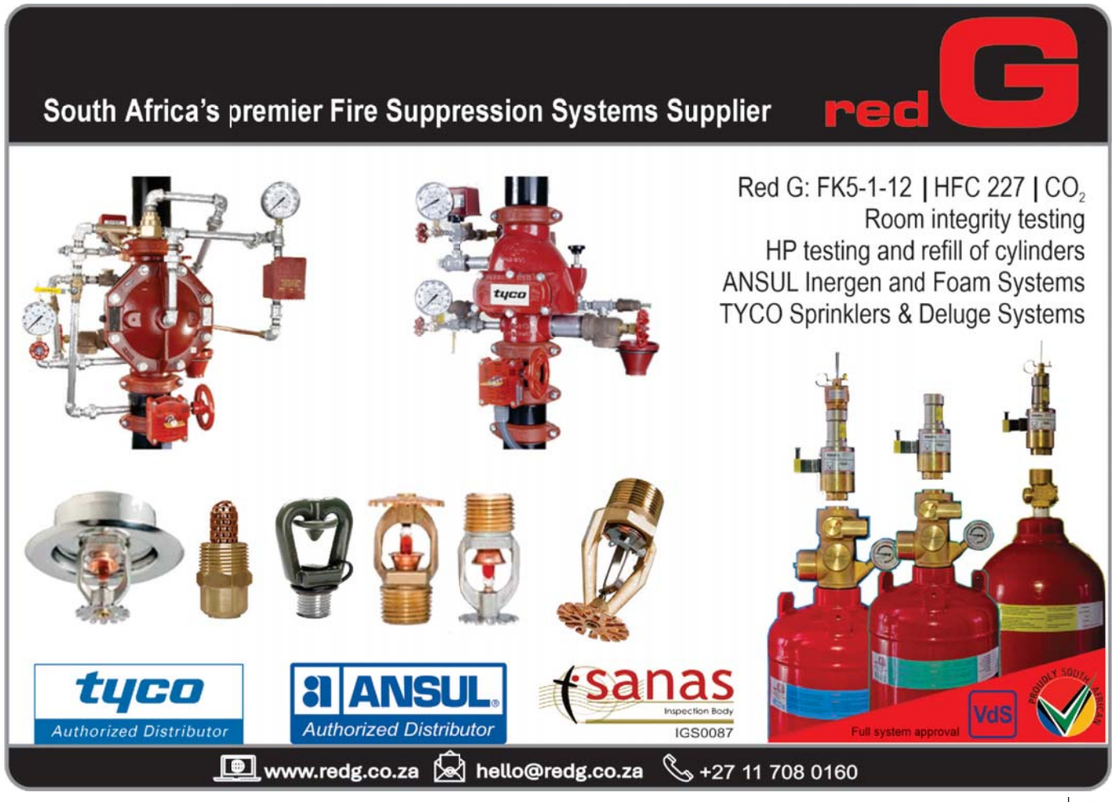
For larger hospitality portfolios, limited local capacity has also pushed some risks into international markets, particularly London. While this can open access to additional capacity, it often comes with significantly higher deductibles, stricter underwriting requirements and more demanding risk engineering expectations.

According to Madziwa, the conversation has shifted from simply buying insurance to demonstrating why a property remains a quality, insurable risk for the insurer.

"With the right data and meaningful risk improvements, insurers do still want to support well-managed hospitality businesses," he says.

"As South Africa's hospitality industry continues to attract visitors seeking authentic safari and bush experiences, thatch roofing is unlikely to disappear. The businesses best positioned for the future will be those that invest proactively in fire prevention, strengthen their risk management practices and work closely with specialist insurance advisers to secure sustainable insurance solutions in an increasingly challenging market."

Photo credits: Wirestock on Magnific; Rawpixel.com on Magnific; Magnific AI; Dorset & Wiltshire Fire and Rescue Service; Kindel Media/Pexels



Cheap extension cords are driving fire risk - warning



South Africans are being urged to exercise extreme caution when purchasing electrical extension cords, following growing concern across the industry about the influx of substandard and non-compliant products into the local market.

Recent warnings from Safehouse, a non-profit organisation that protects businesses and consumers from preventable harm caused by unsafe electrical products and services, highlight a concerning trend in that cheaper extension leads, often sold via online platforms, may use aluminium conductors instead of copper.

While less expensive, aluminium wiring cannot safely carry the same electrical load and is far more prone to degradation, overheating and, ultimately, fire.

"From a fire safety perspective, this is deeply worrying," says Michael van Niekerk, CEO of ASP Fire. "When conductors degrade or overheat, ignition becomes a real possibility, especially in residential environments where extension leads are used continuously and often overloaded."

Compliance failures

South Africa has established safety benchmarks through the South African Bureau of Standards (SABS), with applicable SANS standards governing electrical cables and appliances. However, enforcement remains inconsistent.

The National Regulator for Compulsory Specifications (NRCS), responsible for ensuring compliance, has been criticised for limited market surveillance, particularly in the fast-growing online retail space where many of these products are sold.

"Compliance on paper does not always translate to safety in practice," adds Van Niekerk. "Testing regimes and Letters of Authority are important, but they must be backed by active enforcement and accountability across the supply chain."

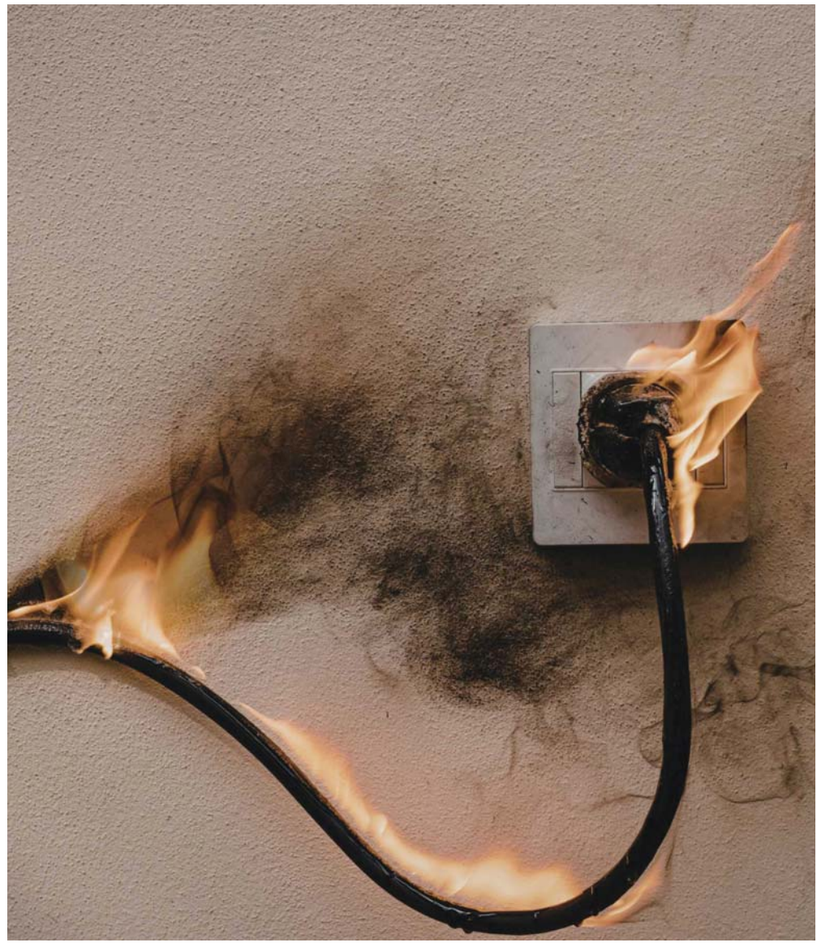
The hidden risks

One of the biggest challenges for consumers is that non-compliant products are not always easy to identify. Price often becomes the only visible indicator. However, the consequences of choosing the cheapest option can be severe.

"Saving a few rand on an extension cable is simply not worth the risk," points out Van Niekerk. "We regularly see how electrical faults escalate into full-scale fires, particularly where poor-quality components are involved."

Common risks associated with substandard extension leads include:

- Overheating due to inadequate current capacity and overloading of multi-plug adaptors.



- Internal conductor breakage, especially with brittle aluminium wiring.
- Increased likelihood of short circuits and ignition.

Strengthen regulation

Encouragingly, the Department of Trade, Industry and Competition (DTIC) has announced tighter controls on imported goods, including the introduction of Certificates of Conformity (CoC) for certain product categories, says ASP Fire.

These certificates must confirm compliance with applicable SANS or recognised standards before products enter the country. Enforcement will be supported by the Border Management Authority and the South African Revenue Service, marking a step towards addressing the influx of unsafe goods.

Reducing fire risk is a shared responsibility between regulators, suppliers, and consumers. "Electrical fires are often preventable," concludes Van Niekerk. "Choosing compliant, quality-assured products, ensuring they are used correctly and installing them on circuits protected by earth leakage circuit breakers is one of the simplest and most effective ways to protect lives and property.

Photo credits: ASP Fire



PROTECTING LIVES.
PROTECTING PROPERTY.

When it comes to fire safety, there's no room for compromise.

For over two decades, Safequip has been at the forefront of fire protection equipment and safety solutions across Africa.

We don't just supply products — we provide peace of mind.

Why Choose Safequip?

- **Comprehensive Fire Solutions:** From extinguishers to sprinkler systems, we cover every aspect of fire protection.
- **Trusted Quality:** SafeQuip product meets SABS and international safety standards.
- **Nationwide Support:** With distribution centers and expert teams across South Africa, we're always within reach.
- **Expert Knowledge:** Our specialists don't just sell, we advise, and support.

Our Product Range

- **Fire Extinguishers & Accessories**
- **Fire Hose Reels & Cabinets**
- **Safety Signage & Equipment**
- **Industrial & Marine Fire Solutions**

Serving Industries That Matter

Construction | Mining | Marine | Retail
Manufacturing | Hospitality | Residential

SafeQuip
QUALITY FIRE SOLUTIONS

info@safequip.co.za www.safequip.co.za

GAUTENG 011 397 7723 **WESTERN CAPE** 021 907 2500
KWAZULU-NATAL 031 563 8807 **EASTERN CAPE** 041 451 0026



PHOTO CREDIT: UNSPLASH

Emissions from timber in home fires are similar to emissions from a vegetation fire

How house fire emissions differ from forest fires

Wildfires have increased in frequency and severity over the past few decades. More fires are burning at the wildland-urban interface (WUI), where homes and other buildings meet the natural landscape – but our understanding of emissions from structure fires is still growing through ongoing research.

Toxic compounds are released by home fires

New research out of the United States, led by the University of Colorado Boulder's Cooperative Institute for Research in Environmental Sciences (CIRES), shows that common synthetic materials used in homes, like plastics and insulation, can release harmful compounds into the air when they catch fire.

But synthetic materials make up only a small fraction of a home. Timber and wood panels make up most of the materials used in some locations around the world, and the burning emissions from those are not so different from a vegetation fire.

The work, published in the academic journal *Environmental Science & Technology*, identifies compounds that are enhanced in smoke from a fire in a residential home.

"Urban fires are becoming more prevalent," says William Dresser, a CIRES research scientist and lead author of the paper. "We've seen some pretty notable examples, such as the [Los Angeles fires of January 2025], so there are emerging questions from an air quality standpoint of how these types of fires change exposures."

Lab burn experiments

Dresser partnered with CIRES Fellow Joost de Gouw and a team from Colorado State University *(CSU)* to explore how different building materials impact fire emissions.

"There's a need to better understand what these emissions look like for structures that contain a complex mixture of different synthetic materials that have unique emission profiles," Dresser said.

CSU scientists led a series of laboratory experiments, burning 18 different building materials in a fume hood to capture emissions. During and after each burn, CIRES researchers sampled the smoke to measure volatile organic compounds (VOCs), a broad group of carbon-based compounds that can impact air quality and human health.

The team found elevated levels of VOCs, including benzene and styrene (compounds that can cause cancer) and other hazardous air pollutants when synthetic materials like plastics or insulation were burned.

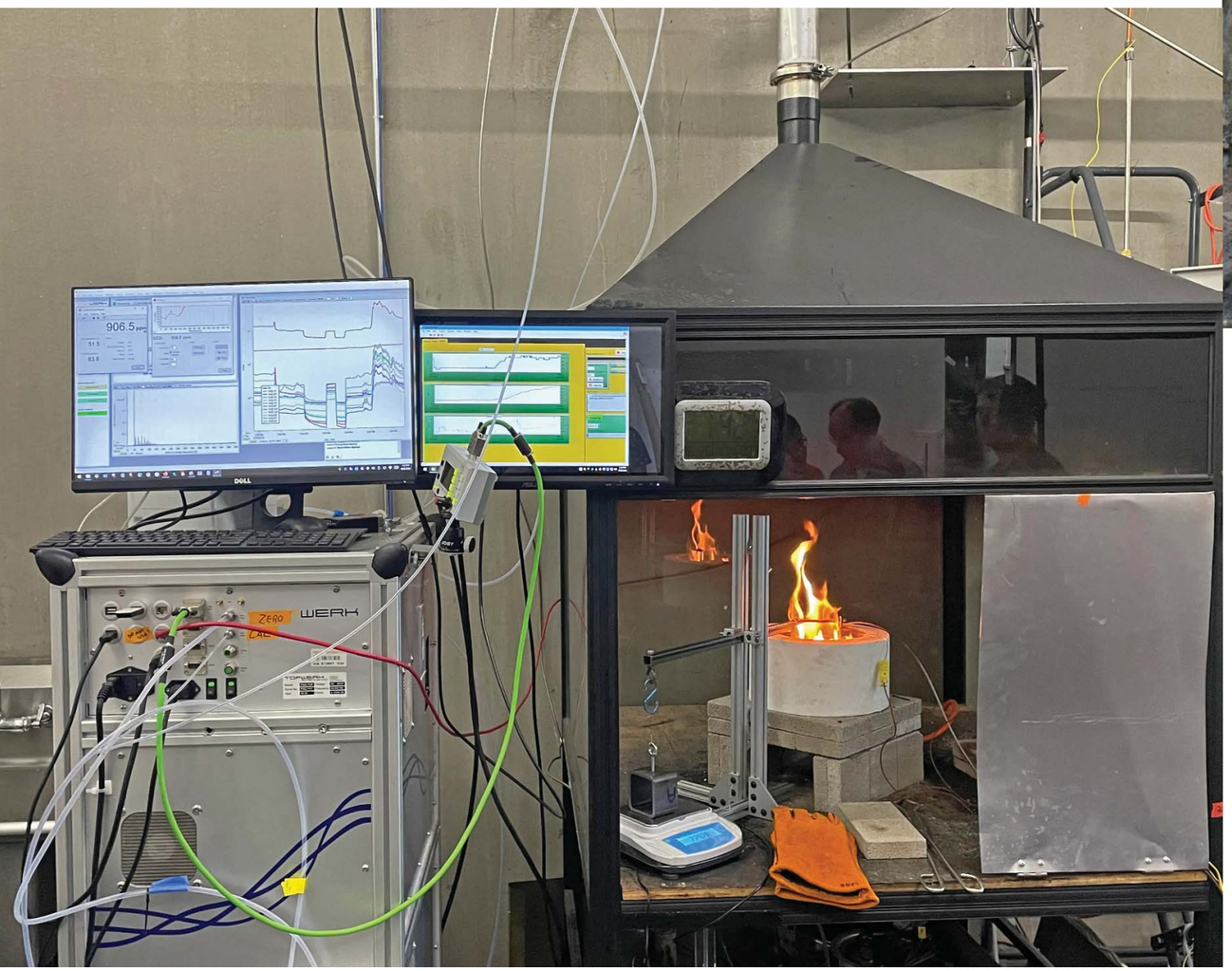


PHOTO CREDIT: WILLIAM DRESSER/CIRES

A fire emissions lab experiment at CSU



PHOTO CREDIT: F. HEKTOR FROM PEXELS

As synthetic materials are a small part of a home fire, the impact of their emissions can be limited

Their results also reveal that many of the synthetic materials have unique, less well-understood emissions, like molecular fragments derived from nylon polymers, that future work will need to explore.

Different types of fires

But when the team considered emissions from a whole-house fire, the picture is more complicated. Synthetic materials exhibit higher VOC emissions, but they only represent a small fraction of the mass of a home.

"We wanted to know – if you make an inventory of materials that mimic a house with all these materials and look at that overall emission, what still stands out?" Dresser explains.

Dresser and the team used estimates for the material composition of a typical home to calculate emissions for a whole-house fire. They then compared the house fire emissions to other fire emission scenarios: a structural wood fire, which is representative of the kind of wood used to build homes, and a natural Douglas fir forest fire, which includes all parts of the tree.

Their results indicate that while the house fire exhibited higher levels of some potentially harmful VOCs, such as benzene and styrene, other VOC emissions did not stand out as clearly from structural wood and forest fires.

"Since synthetic materials are a pretty small part of a home, we found their impact can be muted," Dresser notes. "But it was ... surprising to see the nuanced picture."

What this means for emissions research

The team's work highlights the complexity of fire emission research – and is one of many steps needed to better understand emissions from structure fires.

"Our research shows clearly that some toxic compounds are higher when a home burns, relative to a wildfire," comments fellow researcher Joost de Gouw. "Future work is focused on the compounds that end up in ash, or can be leached from ash into waterways."

You can find out more about the study, titled *'Laboratory Analysis of VOC Emissions from Structural Materials in Wildland-Urban Interface Fires'* here.

Fire protection is part of a connected protection ecosystem

Across South Africa, organisations face increasing pressure to protect people, property and operations from a growing range of fire-related risks.

Ageing infrastructure, changing regulations, shifting building requirements, evolving energy systems, and heightened business continuity concerns are placing greater emphasis on fire protection than ever before.

Fire safety is no longer viewed solely as a compliance requirement. It has become a critical component of operational resilience, risk management, and business continuity planning.

With fire protection becoming an increasingly important component of organisational resilience, Firexpo 2026 formed part of Africa's Integrated Protection Marketplace at Gallagher Convention Centre from 2 to 4 June.

Alongside Securex South Africa, A-OSH EXPO, Facilities Management Expo, and the inaugural RE+ South Africa, the event enabled fire protection professionals to engage not only with fire safety solutions, but also with the wider security, occupational safety, facilities management, and energy sectors that increasingly influence risk management and resilience strategies.



Visitors and exhibitors exchanging insights

"Fire safety is one of those disciplines where preparation, compliance, and operational readiness can have life-changing consequences," says Mark Anderson, Portfolio Director at Montgomery Group Africa.

"Firexpo formed an important part of a much broader industry conversation. Fire protection professionals engaged with specialists, suppliers, consultants, facilities leaders, safety practitioners, and end users who share a common goal of reducing risk, strengthening preparedness and improving organisational resilience."

Over the course of the exhibition, visitors could move from expert discussions to practical engagement with suppliers, technologies and service providers addressing some of the most pressing fire protection challenges facing organisations today.

Practical implementation

Visitors engaged with technologies, specialist services and practical solutions designed to help organisations reduce risk, strengthen compliance, and improve readiness before an incident occurs.

The exhibition floor showcased everything from fire detection and alarm systems to suppression technologies, passive fire protection products, evacuation solutions, monitoring technologies, and integrated fire safety systems serving commercial, industrial, and public environments.

The Firexpo Seminar Theatre added significant value to the visitor experience, providing practical insight into topics affecting the fire protection sector. Sessions addressed regulatory developments, compliance obligations, fire risk management, emerging technologies, fire engineering, inspection requirements and best practices for protecting people and property.

For many visitors, the combination of practical solutions, expert-led content, and direct access to suppliers created a highly productive experience that extended well beyond product evaluation.

When expertise meets real-world challenges

While new technologies generated considerable interest, many of the most valuable discussions focused on the practical realities of protecting people, property and operations in increasingly complex environments.

"Exhibitors reported that conversations were highly focused and commercially relevant, with many discussions centred on active projects, compliance requirements, upgrade programmes, infrastructure investments and operational risk management initiatives," states Anderson.

"That level of engagement created valuable opportunities for suppliers to share expertise, demonstrate practical solutions, and support organisations looking to strengthen preparedness and resilience."

Visitors represented a broad cross-section of decision-makers responsible for fire protection planning, compliance, facilities operations, infrastructure management, workplace safety, organisational resilience and procurement. Many arrived with clearly defined objectives, creating opportunities for focused discussions around practical implementation rather than purely exploratory conversations.

The exhibition also encouraged knowledge sharing across the industry, with visitors and exhibitors exchanging insights on risk reduction, preparedness, regulatory compliance and the practical realities of implementing effective fire protection strategies.

"Firexpo helped us raise awareness of our flammable chemical and lithium-ion battery storage solutions at a time when battery safety is becoming an increasingly important industry discussion. We generated quality leads, explored potential collaborations with other exhibitors, and had valuable conversations throughout the event," says Lizanne Boshoff of Lasec, a leading laboratory equipment and scientific solutions supplier.

"Firexpo exceeded our expectations. We secured



Exhibitors reported that conversations were highly focused and commercially relevant



The co-located platform allowed visitors to explore interconnected solutions

significant business opportunities, generated strong leads and found the collaborative nature of the event particularly valuable. The exhibition provided an excellent overview of developments taking place across the fire protection sector," says De Wet Engelbrecht of Fire Ops SA, a privately owned fire brigade and emergency response service.

Visitors could also gain broader insight into how fire protection contributes to business continuity planning, operational resilience, and long-term risk management strategies.

"We came to Securex specifically, but we were also very impressed with Firexpo. Technology is always changing, and the event gave us an opportunity to see what is trending across the industry. The experience exceeded our expectations, and we were very pleased with what we saw," say Thubelihle and Sbusisio Sobantu of GOAT Systems, a specialist in automation technologies.

No longer alone

Challenges facing organisations rarely fit neatly into a single category. Fire safety decisions increasingly influence workplace safety strategies, security planning, facilities operations, business continuity programmes and energy resilience initiatives.

The co-located platform reflected this reality, allowing visitors to explore interconnected solutions and engage with specialists from across the wider protection and resilience landscape. The introduction of RE+ South Africa added another valuable dimension, particularly as organisations increasingly consider fire safety implications associated with renewable energy systems, battery storage technologies, and changing energy infrastructure.

Next conversations

"Fire protection does not exist in isolation. As organisations increasingly connect fire safety, workplace safety, security, facilities management, and energy resilience into a single risk management strategy, Firexpo will continue to provide a platform where these critical conversations can take place," says Anderson.

The conversations taking place at Firexpo 2026 demonstrated that organisations are becoming increasingly proactive in how they approach fire protection, compliance and resilience. Those discussions continue long after the exhibition doors have closed.

Firexpo returns to Gallagher Convention Centre from 1 to 3 June 2027 as part of Africa's Integrated Protection Marketplace. "For organisations that want to stay connected to emerging technologies, regulatory developments, specialist expertise, and the wider protection ecosystem, early planning for 2027 is already becoming a strategic advantage," says Anderson.

Organisations wishing to exhibit at Firexpo 2027 can contact the Firexpo team on johan.vanheerden@montgomerygroup.com to book a space or capitalise on a sponsorship opportunity.

Photo credit: Montgomery Group

FPASA: The many benefits of belonging



IMAGE BY DC STUDIO ON FREEPIK

The Fire Protection Association of Southern Africa has developed a range of Membership options and technical, training and fire safety management services that are recognised for their quality, professionalism and value.

Our FPASA Membership Benefits will add value to any institution or business having an interest or involvement in fire engineering, fire protection, fire prevention or fire safety management.

Membership Benefits

Membership categories are: Individual, Corporate, Local Government Fire & Disaster Management (LG&DM) Membership – a dedicated category for municipalities – and the special category of Stakeholder Member for contributing insurers.

Among the membership benefits available to the different categories are:

- Special members rates for courses and seminars.
- A membership certificate.
- An electronic membership card.
- Access to back issues of the '*Fire Protection Journal*' and other FPASA publications online.
- Access to the annual National Fire Statistics.
- Online webinars with CPD Points.
- Attendance of seminars at FPASA premises – with exhibiting option.
- Members discounts on local and international publications.
- Use of special FPASA member logo (Signed agreement with T & Cs applying).
- Listed in FPASA's website Membership Directory.
- Listed in the FPASA magazine.
- Venue Hire at reduced cost (classroom or fire ground).
- The option to add other branches/divisions of the same company with full Corporate Membership benefits at a discounted fee (subject to centralised membership billing).

Further details

For information on all Membership Categories and costs, you can download the full Membership Benefits 2026 document here.

Or contact us: (011) 397-1618/9 Ext.221 or e-mail: reception@fpasa.co.za

Corporate members

AAA Civils and Projects (Pty) Ltd	
ACF Technologies (Pty) Ltd	
Act-Safe SHE Consultancy and Training	
Advanced Fire Suppression Technologies	
Alpha Pyrosec cc	
Amakosi Fire (Pty) Ltd	
Amethyst Innovation (Pty) Ltd	
Apex Mechanical Engineering (Pty) Ltd t/a Apex Engineering	
Arksun Fire Equipment cc	
Arquero Technical Support (Pty) Ltd	
Asenza SA (Pty) Ltd	www.asenza.co.za
ASP Fire	www.aspfire.co.za
BA Labour (Pty) Ltd	
Bauwen Consulting (Pty) Ltd	
Billazania Projects (Pty) Ltd	
Bizzy Fire Control (Pty) Ltd	https://bizzyfiresa.co.za
Boleng Fire Services	
Bophelo Emergency Medical Services (Pty) Ltd	
Bracalia Events Management	
Brady Protection Incendie SA (Pty) Ltd	
C3 Shared Services (Pty) Ltd	
Carewell Holdings 5 (Pty) Ltd	
Centa Fire Protection Equipment cc t/a Centa Holdings	www.centa.co.za
Centa Firequip cc t/a Firequip	
Cheetah Fire Services	
Cishumlilo South Africa cc	
Clear Blue Facilities (Pty) Ltd	
Collaborative Risk Applications (Pty) Ltd	
Commercial & Industrial Acceptances (Pty) Ltd	
Cosmo-Dec Everlasting Coatings CC	www.cosmodec.co.za
Credelex (Pty) Ltd	
Delta Built Environment Consultants	www.deltabec.com
DK2R Engineering t/a DK2R Fire & Safety Services	
DLN Consulting (Pty) Ltd	
DMS Fire and Security Systems (Pty) Ltd	
DoseTech (Pty) Ltd	
DSS Fire Systems (Pty) Ltd	www.dssfire.co.za
Dushka Tech Solutions (Pty) Ltd	
E Protection Services (Pty) Ltd	
ECH Consultancy (Pty) Ltd	www.echconsultancy.co.za
Electro Fire and Safety Systems (Pty) Ltd	
Electrotron (Pty) Ltd	info@electrotron.co.za
Elite Fire Protection 370 (Pty) Ltd	
Emanzini Investment (Pty) Ltd	
Enact Training Solutions (Pty) Ltd	
Enigma Automotive Forensic Services CC	
Enos Solutions (Pty) Ltd	
Equipro Business Risk Solutions (Pty) Ltd	www.equipro.co.za
Eye Sizwe KZN Mechanical Consulting Engineers	
Ezingeni Security and Cleaning (Pty) Ltd	
F M S - Fire & Medical Services CC	
Failsafe Fire Projects (Pty) Ltd	www.failsafefire.co.za
FCI Fire (Pty) Ltd	
Fire & Explosion Suppression Systems (Pty) Ltd	
Fire Access Control Networks (Pty) Ltd	
Fire Bee Investments (Pty) Ltd - Eswatini	
Fire Brand Solutions (Pty) Ltd	
Fire Check (Pty) Ltd	
Fire Risk Solutions and Maintenance (Pty) Ltd	www.firerisk.co.za
Fire Risk Systems t/a F.R.S (Pty) Ltd	
Fire Security International	
Fire Unlimited	
Firearm and Self Defence Academy	
Firetech (Pty) Ltd	www.firetechcc.co.za
Firetech and Products (Pty) Ltd - Botswana	
Fireworx1475 (Pty) Ltd	
Flametec Fire Equipment Services	
Frigavac Building Technologies (Pty) Ltd	www.frigavac.co.za
FS Systems (Pty) Ltd	
FTS Tanks (Pty) Ltd	
Future Mobility Pty Ltd	www.future-mobility.co.za
GFG (Pty) Ltd	
G-Fire Suppression Systems (Pty) Ltd	
Globrite Trading 31 cc	
Gobodla Risk Firm (Pty) Ltd	
Go Gourmet Mushrooms (Pty) Ltd - No website provided	
Greenway Farms (Pty) Ltd	
Green Whistle (Pty) Ltd	https://greenwhistle.co.za
Hank Fire (Pty) Ltd	https://www.hankfire.co.za
Haygrove Heaven (Pty) Ltd	
Highveld Fire Safety	
Hitshembile Business Enterprises (Pty) Ltd	
Hoedspruit Fire & General (Pty) Ltd	
ICAT International Consulting & Trading (Pty) Ltd	
Igagu Enterprise	
Ignis Forensic Fire Investigations & Prevention	
Industrial Fire and Hazard Control (Pty) Ltd	
Ingcebo Yamazulu (Pty) Ltd	
Institute of Emergency First Aiders cc	www.iefa.co.za
Invictus Fire Specialists (Pty) Ltd	
ISF SFP (Pty) Ltd	www.isfgroup.co.za
Jerico Training and Fire Industries (Pty) Ltd	
JJ Fires	
JOIFF Company Limited by Guarantee - COMP Ireland	
Jozini Municipality	www.jozini.gov.za
Katale Trading & Projects CC	
Katorus Fire Systems (Pty) Ltd	
KET Farms (Pty) Ltd	
King Price Insurance Limited (FSP 43862)	
KNS Fire (Pty) Ltd	
Kouga Fire Protection - Fire Retardant Applications	
Kutama Engineering (Pty) Ltd	
Kyoto Industrial Components	
Lebo Tebo Trading and Projects	
LIP-Madiba-SA Trading and Projects	
Little Creek Fire and Security cc	
Little Eden Society	www.littleedenorg.za
Long Avenue Investments CC t/a Phoenix Fire	
Logivest 43 (Pty) Ltd	
LO Tantsi Fire Consultants	
Lotus Plumbers cc t/a Lotus Civils and Fire	
Kholisani Developers and Project Managers - No website provided	
Lucky Fire Services	
LVG Plants (Pty) Ltd	lvgplant.co.za
Mahoc Investments (Pty) Ltd	
Maninga Engineering (Pty) Ltd	www.maningaengineering.co.za
Masalal Packers (Pty) Ltd	
Mashishimale Fire and Safety (Pty) Ltd	
Master Fire Industries	
MHI Risk Engineers (Pty) Ltd	www.mhiriskengineers.com
Mkholi Consulting (Pty) Ltd	www.mkholiconsulting.com
Mmabela Projects	
Mmakgoge Group	
MP Fire Solutions (Pty) Ltd	
MpumaCare Medical Support (Pty) Ltd	
MRDI Project Management and General Suppliers (Pty) Ltd	
Nemesis Events	
Newcastle Local Municipality	
Njabs Investments	
Nlilo Engineering (Pty) Ltd	
NMC Fire Pty Ltd t/a Unique Fire	
Nomakanjani Mining Supplies & Services	
North Rand Fire Services cc	
Novateur (Pty) Ltd	www.novateurza.com
Ntobe Solutions (Pty) Ltd	
Ocacile Fire Services (Pty) Ltd	
Ognax Trading CC	
Onri Industries (Pty) Ltd	
Optimum Fire Protection (Pty) Ltd	www.fireseal.co.za
Orchard View Packaging t/a Orchard View (Pty) Ltd	
Osthenjwa Holdings (Pty) Ltd	
Pasiffiresa (Pty) Ltd	
Pipemakers (Pty) Ltd t/a National Workshop Equipment	
Practical Mining Innovators (Pty) Ltd	
Prana Facilities Management	
Premier Fire Services CC	www.premierfire.co.za
Prime Safety Solutions	
Pro Secure (Pty) Ltd	
Protection Projects (Pty) Ltd	
Protect-O-Burn (Pty) Ltd	
PT Alarms Fire and Security (Pty) Ltd -	www.ptalarms.co.za
Pyrocote KZN (Pty) Ltd	
R Allen Investments cc t/a Eagle Fire Control	
Rainbow Reservoirs (Pty) Ltd	
Rapid Onamandla	
Rapid Spill Response	
Raumix Aggregates (Pty) Ltd	
RBPMM (Pty) Ltd	
Reforming Engineering & Technological Solutions t/a RETS (Pty) Ltd	
Rehlee Industries (Pty) Ltd	
Rehoboth Fire and Safety	
Rheinmetall Denel Munition (Pty) Ltd	
Riskonet Africa (Pty) Ltd	
Riskscope (Pty) Ltd	www.riskscope.ca.za
Riverside Katriver Farms (Pty) Ltd	
Rural Metro Emergency Management Services (Pty) Ltd	
SA Fire and Emergency Services (Pty) Ltd	www.safe247.co.za
S A Firehouse (Pty) Ltd. t/a Fire Risk S A	
Safeguard Fire Security Pmb. CC	
Safequip (Pty) Ltd	
Sappi Southern Africa Limited	
SCC Systems (Pty) Ltd	
Scott-Safe	
Sedgwick South Africa (Pty) Ltd c/o EFI Global South Africa	
Sennis Electrical	www.senniselectrical.co.za
Sereteledi Building Construction & Projects	
Servicios Empresaviales Holdings (Pty) Ltd	
Shayimpi Security and Trading Enterprise (Pty) Ltd	
Sichaka and Sons (Pty) Ltd	
Sidepoint Trading 161 (Pty) Ltd	
Silver Streak Fire	
Sinokuthemba Fire Equipment	
Skopas Systems	
Songo Collective t/a Songo Engineers	
South African Forestry Training College	
Special Risk Solutions (Pty) Ltd	
Specialised Fire Technology Rational Designs (Pty) Ltd	
Sperosensors & Instruments (Pty) Ltd	
Spoormaker and Partners (Pty) Ltd	
Spot-On Fire Controls (Pty) Ltd	
STI Risk	
Super Servants (Pty) Ltd	
Sysman Public Safety Systems (Pty) Ltd	
Tarrow Holdings t/a Tarrow Fire Protection & Security	
Technopol SA (Pty) Ltd	www.technopol.co.za
TEFLA Group	www.tefla.co.za
Tempus Risk Consulting	
The 911 Group (Pty) Ltd	
The Only Mlanje Trading and Projects (Pty)	
Thermal Insulation Products & Systems Association SA (TIPSASA)	
Thero Services (Pty) Ltd	
Thondose Engineers Pty Ltd	www.thondose.co.za
TK Integrated Fire and Security	
Tocoforce (Pty) Ltd	
Torpedo Loss Control Consultants cc t/a TLC Fire	
Trade Factor Fire (Pty) Ltd	
TransFire (Pty) Ltd	
Transkei Quarries (Pty) Ltd	
Trap Fire & Safety (Pty) Ltd	
Tresso Trading 750 (Pty) Ltd	www.vilafonte.com
Trustfire and Security Systems	
TTE Groups	
Tulima Packing (Pty) Ltd	
Two and Six Projects (Pty) Ltd	
Umlilo Protection Management Services cc	
Umlilo Systems cc	
Umsebenti Wetfu Business Enterprise	
Umveli Wase Afrika (Pty) Ltd	
Unique Fire Solutions (Pty) Ltd	
Vaal Triangle Fire Services (Pty) Ltd	
Vancouver Consolidated Investments	
VDS Fire & Safety Appliances (Pty) Ltd	www.vdsfireandsafety.co.za
Vebi Consulting (Pty) Ltd	www.vebiconsulting.co.za
Veritas Engineering and Project Management Consultants	
Versailles Beleggings Trust	
Wozungithathe Business Enterprise	
Wulf Development (Pty) Ltd	
X-IT Solar	
Xolani MaTshawe Emergency Solutions (Pty) Ltd	www.xmes.co.za
YBF Manufacturers (Pty) Ltd	
Zawia Ebrahim Trust	

Ultraflow empowers industrial firefighters with pumping ability

The Catalyst (JOIFF), Q3 2024

Stephen M. Washington

Delivering a high-capacity direct-inject foam proportioning system for the demanding industrial sector is crucial. Waterous Aquis Ultraflow provides the necessary flow rates to empower industrial firefighters when they need it most.

What sets it apart is its exceptional pumping capability. The Waterous CRU-2 pump with inducer can deliver 15,000 L/min from draft and over 22,700 L/min with a pressurised intake, all while simultaneously injecting a choice between 606/1135/1893 L/min of foam concentrate in any of up to 16 discharges.

Additionally, Ultraflow has GPS position tracking, enabling coordinated deployment and positioning of apparatus during major industrial firefighting incidents.

Catastrophic multi-death fires occurring in the United States

NFPA Journal, Vol 118. No. 1 - Spring 2024

Stephen G. Badger

A New York City apartment building fire that killed 17 people led the list of deadliest US fires in 2022, which recorded a notable increase over similar fires the year before.

At 10:55 a.m. on January 9, 2022, New York City firefighters were notified by automatic fire alarms and calls reporting a fire and smoke in a high-rise building in the Bronx.

First responders arrived to see fire coming from windows on the third floor and heavy smoke throughout the 19-story, 120-unit apartment building of unprotected ordinary construction. Alarms were sounding and many residents had self-evacuated.

High-rises and NFPA 13 residential sprinklers

Fire and Rescue International Vol 7. No 5. 2024

Tim de Wit

Striving towards safe buildings from a fire safety and fire prevention point of view remain the key objectives of designers.

New challenges are facing designers every day, not only in South Africa but around the world. Alternative energy, energy storage and socio-economic circumstances will immediately come to mind.

Fire statistics indicate a very sharp increase in fire deaths and fire losses. More concerning is that residential occupancies lead this trend. Infrastructure availability and consistency such as secure water supplies, electricity and maintenance response contribute to the complexity of safe building designs.

PHOTO CREDIT: WATEROUS

PHOTO CREDIT: TONY PHAM/PEXELS

PHOTO CREDIT: SHERISSA R./PEXELS

PHOTO CREDIT: STEVEN TERBLANCHE/WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Wildfires in South Africa are set to increase markedly

Fire and Rescue International, Vol 7. No 5. 2024

Professor Tracy-Lynn Field

As climate change drives temperature increases and lower precipitation in southern Africa, research has found that there is likely to be an increase in the number of wildfires in regions that are already hot, dry and water scarce.

Massive wildfires broke out in South Africa's KwaZulu-Natal province on 12 and 13 July 2024, killing six firefighters who were trapped in a fire and seven other people. The same fires killed 1,600 livestock and burnt 14,000 hectares of land.

Designing systems to withstand change and socio-political shifts in attitude

Fire Protection Engineering, Q3 2025 Issue #107

Daniel Wake

When news broke that the US Environmental Protection Agency planned to roll back emissions regulations, I started to critically examine its impact on construction projects. Environmental regulations – and deregulations, for that matter – heavily influence fire protection design and solutions. With regulations capable of changing drastically and suddenly, how are engineers expected to design systems that withstand the ebbs and flows of socio-political shifts?

Regulatory uncertainty has prompted engineers to practice heightened caution in their building systems, particularly in emerging markets with rapidly evolving technologies and business demands. Many hesitate to specify or allow certain chemicals in their fire protection systems because while one agent may be permitted today, predicting its future use remains challenging.

Fixing methods for open-state cavity barriers

Fire Protection Engineering, Q3 2025 Issue #107

Lee Nichols

Horizontal open-state cavity fire barriers (OSCBs) are critical elements in the fire and life safety strategy and moisture management of ventilated exterior wall assemblies, including rainscreen wall coverings.

They permit ventilation and drainage under normal conditions and inhibit fire spread once the intumescent component of the barrier exfoliates to fully seal the concealed cavity after heat activation at approximately 130°C.

For long-term performance and effective compartmentation, OSCBs must be securely and appropriately fixed to the internal substrate. It is therefore vital that fire protection engineers understand the different types of fixing methods, the risks posed by insecure fixings and inadequate retention, and the requirements for ensuring that their projects adhere to best practices and comply with industry standards.

PHOTO CREDIT: IVAN S./PEXELS

PHOTO CREDIT: ARC BUILDING SOLUTIONS, LEEDS UK

Nelson Mandela Bay makes emergency services appointment



Nelson Mandela Bay Municipality recently announced the appointment of John Conway as the new Senior Director of Fire and Emergency Services. His appointment became effective on 1 September 2026.

He brings extensive experience in fire administration and emergency response to the role. In this new position he will oversee all departmental operations, strategic planning, community safety initiatives and emergency management services at the municipality.

Key areas within the municipality include the major city of Gqeberha (formerly Port Elizabeth) and the towns of Kariega (formerly Uitenhage), Despatch and Colchester.

Before joining NMBM Fire and Emergency Services, Conway served as Chief Fire Officer for Blue Crane Route Municipality (2015-2024) and Dr Beyers Naudé Local Municipality for three months, where he implemented fire administration, emergency response and successfully established the municipality's Fire and Emergency Services Department as the Chief Fire Officer.

He commenced his career with the Port Elizabeth Municipality in September 1985 and has extensive experience in local government and fire service management spanning several decades.



Collaboration and leadership

In an address delivered during his welcoming ceremony, Conway expressed his appreciation for the warm welcome and the opportunity to take on the responsibility of leading the Fire and Emergency Services Directorate.

He highlighted the importance of teamwork, collaboration and strong leadership in responding to emergencies and ensuring the safety of communities across Nelson Mandela Bay.

Conway further emphasised his commitment to working closely with the Municipality's teams and stakeholders to strengthen service delivery and build a safer, more resilient metro.

Among his qualifications are a BCom Hons, majoring in Business Management, Strategic Management and Entrepreneurship; a Certificate in Municipal Finance and Administration (NQF Level 6); Aviation Training, comprising eight FSAC-accredited modules; Diploma in Fire Technology Associate; Graduate Diploma in Fire Technology.



Photos: Nelson Mandela Bay Municipality

Ekurhuleni opens new Katlehong fire station



The City of Ekurhuleni recently opened the new Katlehong Fire Station on the East Rand. It will serve the Kathorus (Katlehong-Vosloorus) region.

Located at 2096 Letsoho Street, it brings the city's firefighting network to 30 stations, significantly improving emergency response capabilities and turnaround times across the region.

The official opening was conducted by Executive Mayor, Alderman Nkosindiphile Xhakaza, who said it was a significant milestone, given that the project had to overcome a number of hurdles – including delays caused by the Covid-19 pandemic, contractual issues and difficult soil conditions in the area.

"We are fixing local government and it all starts with such programmes. Our people are tired of speech and just need tangible service delivery. Let us continue to talk less and do more," the Mayor said.

As part of the official opening, Ekurhuleni Disaster and Emergency Management Services personnel conducted a fire safety demonstration to educate residents on the dangers associated with different heat energy sources commonly used for cooking, lighting and heating.





"The demonstration highlights the preparedness of our emergency response teams, who stand ready to respond to any emergency and protect lives and properties across our communities," the city said in a social media post.

Photo credit: City of Ekurhuleni

Overstrand gets new hazardous materials firefighting equipment



The capabilities of Overstrand Fire and Rescue Services have been boosted by the handover of new hazardous materials (HAZMAT) firefighting equipment, strengthening the municipality's capacity to respond to incidents involving dangerous goods.

Transportation, storage and processing of dangerous goods can pose significant risks to communities, particularly where specialised chemical, biological and radioactive detection and mitigation capabilities are limited.

Acknowledging this, the Western Cape Department of Local Government, through its Sub-Directorate, Fire and Rescue Services, contributed R500,000 towards the new equipment, while Overstrand Municipality contributed a further R74,000.

The handover took place in August at the Hermanus Fire Station. The equipment includes:

- Four Level A Responder Suits (CPS 7900). These gas-tight suits provide maximum protection against hazardous substances.
- Four Level B Splash Suits (SPC 4900) to provide protection against hazardous liquids and splashes.
- Two Thermal Imaging Cameras to assist firefighters in locating people and heat sources in smoke-filled or low-visibility conditions.
- Six Oversized Over-Drums to safely contain and isolate toxic waste.
- Specialised gloves and multi-coloured lane demarcation cones to protect fire crew and secure dangerous incident scenes while guiding personnel safely.



"For our firefighters, protective equipment is not a luxury. It is an essential part of ensuring that they can safely enter dangerous environments and carry out their duties effectively," said the Executive Mayor of Overstrand Municipality, Councillor Archie Klass, during the handover ceremony.

He added that the day was not simply about the handing over of equipment. It was about building capacity, strengthening partnerships and ensuring that the Overstrand Municipality is better equipped to protect lives, property and livelihoods when emergencies occur.



He noted that the thermal imaging camera, in particular, will enhance the ability of the firefighting teams to identify heat sources and locate persons during fire and rescue operations, especially in conditions where visibility is severely compromised.

Fire Chief Lester Smith said municipal fire services rely on co-funding. "It's not only about equipment. It is also about Provincial Government investing in our staff and making sure our firefighters receive the training they need."

Santam P4RR programme

Overstrand also received firefighting equipment valued at R374,000 from insurer Santam through its Partnerships for Risk and Resilience (P4RR) programme.

This includes two Bluetooth flow meters, a positive pressure ventilation (PPV) system, ten 25mm hoses, and four foam tube nozzles. The flow meters will enable firefighters to measure water pressure at hydrants, while the PPV system will be useful during structural fires to remove smoke from burning dwellings.

Dr Moses Khangale, Manager for Stakeholder Programmes at Santam, explained that the Partnerships for Risk and Resilience programme is designed to help selected municipalities reduce their vulnerability to fire, flood and storm disasters. He added that Santam provides support to 110 municipalities across South Africa.

He emphasised the importance of collaboration, saying that stakeholders should work together rather than against each other. He also urged the municipality to take good care of the equipment, noting that it is expensive and plays an important role in protecting lives and property.

Photos: Western Cape Provincial Government

Knysna boosts its firefighting fleet





Knysna Municipality recently acquired two new light single-cab 4x4 firefighting vehicles and a double-cab bakkie, further strengthening its emergency response capabilities and commitment to community safety.

The official handover ceremony took place on 10 June 2026 in Rheenendal, a small community 12km west of Knysna, where one of the firefighting vehicles will be permanently stationed to improve response times and service delivery in the area.

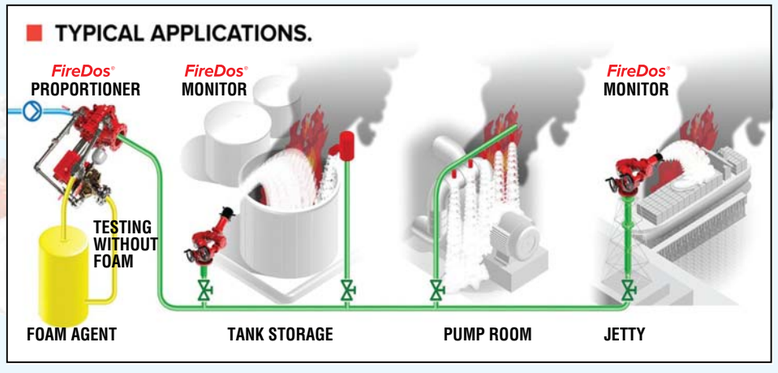
This investment, valued at R4.6-million, was made possible through a combination of grant funding and the municipality's own funding.

"These new vehicles will enhance our ability to respond swiftly and effectively to fires and other emergencies, helping to protect human lives, property and the environment," the municipality says in a statement.

"We remain committed to building safer, more resilient communities through continuous investment in critical emergency services infrastructure."

Photos: Knysna Municipality via Facebook

dosetech fire 35
special risk fire protection
Future proof your fire protection system with
25 YEARS AUTHORIZED PARTNER OF FireDos
• Efficient • Effective
• Easy to use & test
ALL INDUSTRIAL, MOBILE, SPRINKLER REQUIREMENTS
+27 (0) 861 111 544
Mike – mgf@dosetech.co.za
firedos@dosetech.co.za
www.dosetech.co.za



FireDos foam dosing proportioners and skids • Monitors and water cannons • Mobile dosing and monitor trailers • Bund, tank top and rim pourers

FIREFLEX
The new TOTALPAC® 4

Unique Features: Power, Reliability, and Convenience
Meeting the highest standards: UL & FM approved

Compact and Aesthetic Design
Simplified and compact trim with VXD and VXR Viking valves
New smaller footprint for certain system sizes

Total Control and Safety
Self-contained unit prewired to Viking VFR-500 releasing control panel





VIKING®

Designed for Easy Installation and Maintenance

38 YEARS EST. 1988

CONTACT INFORMATION
TEL . +27 11 396 1800 / 1 / 2
EMAIL . info@firequip.co.za
www.firequip.co.za

FIREQUIP®
EQUIPMENT YOU CAN COUNT ON, PEOPLE YOU CAN TRUST

Fitness of leaders has positive impact on team readiness



For firefighters, physical fitness is a matter of safety, survival and long-term health. And while past research has largely focused on dissecting individual habits, a new study has revealed that station leaders play a critical role in shaping firefighters' physical readiness.

An international collaboration between researchers in the United States and Dr Lee Brown from the University of East London (UEL) in the UK examined the annual fitness testing data from 838 firefighters across 99 fire stations and explored whether the physical fitness of station crew leadership was linked with the fitness levels of the firefighters they supervised.

The study, published in the academic publication *Journal of Occupational and Environmental Medicine*, found that crews staffed with a fit and actively engaged leadership element scored noticeably higher on physical readiness tests than those without.

Scores were significantly lower in crews staffed by a single leader only, suggesting that a complete leadership structure creates better environments to instil healthy routines.

"These findings align with the concept of 'leading from the front'. When station leaders actively maintain their fitness and participate in training alongside their crews, it helps establish shared standards of readiness and reinforces a culture of wellness," says the co-author of the report, Dr Lee Brown, Senior Lecturer and Researcher at UEL.

"While in the past health and wellness interventions in fire services primarily focused on individual behaviours, the research suggests that departments looking to improve operational readiness should consider targeting the individual crews and those leading them."

The study is expected to have a practical impact across the fire and rescue sector. The findings have been presented to the National Fire Chiefs Council and the Fire Brigade Union in the UK, and used to help develop an industry White Paper on firefighter tactical readiness for the National Strength and Conditioning Association in the US.

Comments Dr Joel Martin, lead author of the study: "We already have strong evidence that physical fitness is critical for firefighter health, injury prevention and occupational performance.

"The challenge has shifted from understanding why fitness matters to understanding how departments can successfully build and sustain a culture of fitness. Our findings suggest that the crew environment and leadership may be important pieces of that puzzle and provide a new direction for implementing fitness initiatives within the fire service."



Dr Martin continues: "I've repeatedly heard that crew culture and the attitudes of company officers play an important role in whether physical training becomes part of the daily routine.

"While our study did not measure those behaviours directly, it provides quantitative evidence that leadership fitness is associated with firefighter fitness and highlights the need to better understand how leadership influences implementation of fitness and wellness initiatives."

You can find out more about the study, titled *'Leading From the Front: Leadership Fitness Is Associated with Fire Station Crew Fitness'* here.

Photo credits: University of East London, UK; Koega Fire & Rescue Services

Aerobic fitness is fundamental

The Mountain Tactical Institute is a strength, conditioning and research organisation in the US that designs targeted physical training programmes, gear tests, and operational research for firefighters and similar personnel.

It says aerobic fitness is fundamental for firefighter readiness, safety and longevity. Firefighting tasks – especially when combined with the added burden of personal protective equipment (PPE) and self-contained breathing apparatus – require physical capacities that often exceed the minimum National Fire Protection Association (NFPA) aerobic fitness guideline.

Firefighters with poor aerobic fitness face multiple compounding risks: they fatigue earlier, perform more slowly, increase risks to their team and themselves, and are more likely to suffer cardiac events or injuries under stress. Even seemingly moderate fireground activities can become vigorous or near-maximal in intensity once gear is worn.

Moreover, participation in regular vigorous exercise can dramatically lower the risk of sickle cell disease (SCD), while low-frequency exercise habits leave firefighters highly vulnerable.

"Departments must recognise that operational effectiveness and firefighter safety are directly tied to aerobic conditioning," the Mountain Tactical Institute states.

"Annual health screenings, fitness programmes emphasising cardiovascular endurance, and education about the effects of gear on performance must become standard practice."



PHOTO CREDIT: FRANK SCHULENBURG/WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

The Dixie Fire in California on 22 July 2021 produces a pyrocumulus cloud

How wildfires cause extreme weather patterns as they burn

By Yunyao Li, Assistant Professor of Earth and Environmental Sciences, University of Texas at Arlington, USA. Her research focuses on wildfire air quality and health impact, atmospheric composition, emission, real-time air quality forecasts, remote sensing, and data assimilation. Originally published in *The Conversation*.

We often think about weather controlling wildfires: dry air, heat, wind and lightning help determine when fires start and how quickly they spread.

However, once a wildfire becomes intense enough, the relationship can flip. Instead of simply responding to the weather, the fire begins to create its own weather.

I study wildfires and air quality at the University of Texas at Arlington. Here are four key ways wildfires influence the weather around them:

1. Updrafts and fire tornadoes

Wildfires release a large amount of heat. As the air above the flames heats up rapidly, it becomes lighter than the surrounding air. As a result, the warm air rises.

This upward motion creates a powerful current of air known as an updraft. In some cases, the rising air becomes so strong that it begins to spin, forming a fire whirl, also known as a fire tornado.

The process is very similar to how a typical tornado forms, though fire tornadoes tend to be smaller and, because they feed off the heat, confined to the fire area.

2. Fire clouds and thunderstorms

The rising plume of smoke and hot gases also contains water vapour released from burning vegetation and the surrounding atmosphere. As the plume rises, the water vapour cools and condenses into tiny cloud droplets, forming a cloud directly above the fire.

Scientists call these clouds pyrocumulus, or fire clouds.

As water vapour condenses, it releases additional heat, making the rising air even more buoyant. If the fire is intense enough and the atmosphere is unstable, the cloud can continue expanding upward into the upper troposphere. It may eventually develop into a pyrocumulonimbus cloud – a thunderstorm generated by the fire itself.

3. Fire-generated lightning

As the pyrocumulus cloud rises above the point in the atmosphere where the air temperature drops below freezing, cloud droplets begin to freeze, producing ice crystals, supercooled water droplets and graupel – a soft version of hail.

Collisions among these particles separate positive and negative electric charges within the cloud. Over time, the charge imbalance becomes strong enough to produce lightning.

Some of these lightning strikes can ignite new fires beyond the original fire perimeter, making firefighters' jobs even harder.

In late July 2026, a severe wildfire near Saumos in southwestern France became intense enough to generate a

PHOTO CREDIT: MARVIN VETTER/OREGON DEPARTMENT OF FORESTRY



Forestry officials captured this image of a fire whirl during the Douglas Complex fires in 2013 at Rabbit Mountain, Oregon, USA

PHOTO CREDIT: JEREMY A. GREENE/WIKIMEDIA COMMONS



A pyrocumulus cloud rises above a wildfire in the Angeles National Forest in Southern California in 2012

pyrocumulonimbus cloud. Lightning from the storm ignited new fires outside the original burn area, allowing the fire to spread beyond its initial blaze.

4. Smoke can change weather downwind

Wildfire smoke can also affect weather far from the flames. Smoke can travel hundreds or even thousands of kilometres. Along the way, it can influence how clouds form and how lightning develops.

Smoke contains large numbers of tiny particles. These particles act as seeds on which water vapour condenses to form cloud droplets. Scientists call these seeds cloud condensation nuclei. When wildfire smoke arrives over a region, it increases the number of cloud condensation nuclei in the atmosphere. As a result, the same amount of water is divided among many more cloud droplets, making each droplet smaller.

Smaller droplets take longer to merge into raindrops, which can delay rainfall or shift it to another location downwind. This is one reason why forecasting precipitation becomes more challenging during major wildfire events.

Scientists have also found that wildfire smoke can alter lightning patterns in downwind thunderstorms.

Under normal conditions, about 90% of cloud-to-ground lightning carries a negative charge, while positive-charge cloud-to-ground lightning is relatively rare. However, studies have reported unusually large numbers of positive-charge lightning strikes in smoke-affected storms.

Positive lightning is more powerful and damaging than negative lightning. It carries larger electrical currents, lasts longer and releases more energy. As a result, it is more likely to ignite new wildfires and can pose greater risks to people and infrastructure.

In some smoke-affected thunderstorms, positive flashes accounted for more than 40% of all cloud-to-ground lightning. In the most extreme cases, the fraction exceeded 90%, meaning that nearly all cloud-to-ground lightning was positively charged.



PHOTO CREDIT: IMAGE BY MAGNIFIC

Once a wildfire becomes intense enough, it begins to create its own weather

Living with fire and its consequences

The next time wildfire smoke turns the sky hazy, remember that the smoke is not simply drifting through the atmosphere – it is becoming part of the atmosphere.

Wildfires and their smoke can shape clouds, rainfall and lightning in ways we are only beginning to understand. As large wildfires become more frequent, living with them will require more than fighting fires. We must also learn to anticipate and adapt to their far-reaching effects on air quality, health and even the weather.

Watch a YouTube video here of a towering pyrocumulus cloud developing over the Gold Mountain Fire in western Colorado.

This article is republished from The Conversation under a Creative Commons license. Read the original here.

THE CONVERSATION

Membership listing

Tel: 072 580 7318

E-Mail: admin@fdia.co.za

Web page: www.fdia.co.za

Member No	Member Type	Company	Division	Contact	Address	Telephone	E-mail
PROSPECT COMPANIES							
FD2612	PROSPECT	**Alfa Fire (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Anthony Joubert	10 September Street SAE Business Park Unit 5B Middelburg 1050	013 246 1136 083 260 8138	biance@alfafire.co.za
FD2509	PROSPECT	**Altra Medical Productions cc**	**Detection**	Jaco Scholtz	P.O. Box 884 Henly on Klip 1961	0861 111 504 079 635 9951	scholtz@altramed.co.za
FD2514	PROSPECT	**Amantla Fire Systems cc**	**Detection**	Andre van Dyk	45 Roselaan Wilgehof Bloemfontein	072 887 7305	andre@amantlafire.co.za
FD2607	PROSPECT	**C3 Shared Services (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Motselisi Mokhutlole	Private Bag X121 Halfway House Midrand 1685	011 312 2041 072 812 5489	mmokhutlole@c3ss.com
FD2515	PROSPECT	**C4 Fire and Security National (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Carlo Le Brun	Klapmuts, Simondium Road Guild, Paarl 7620	082 055 6337	sales@c4fire.co.za
FD2602	PROSPECT	**East Coast Distributors cc t/a Fire King**	**Detection**	Keval Roopchand	60 Balcomb Street Kwa Dukuza KZN 4449	032 552 7712 061 894 0458	info@fireking.co.za
FD2603	PROSPECT	**Electrotron (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Naomi Bester	Suite MW 637 Private Bag X1838 Middelburg	013 246 2655 084 042 5485	fireadmin@electrotron.co.za
FD2502	PROSPECT	**Fire Genie Equipment (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Ryland Naidoo	17 Fith Ave Alberton North Johannesburg	011 493 0110 083 558 5706	ryland@fgequipment.co.za
FD2503	PROSPECT	**Fire Genie Systems (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Sumayia	8 7th Avenue Edenvale Johannesburg	011 420 1106 065 885 7295	admin@fireg.co.za
FD2510	PROSPECT	**Katale Trading and Projects cc**	**Detection**	Mahlatsi Maphoto	5072 Vleilloerie Street Laphalale 555	014 312 0004 082 398 4826	info@katale.co.za
FD2504	PROSPECT	**Mesong Fire & Safety Equipment**	**Detection**	Pity Mothupi	PO Box 1200 Bendor 699	015 223 3452 061 493 6750	info@mesongfire.co.za
FD2518	PROSPECT	**Ramsin Industrial Supplies cc t/a Fire Unlimited cc**	**Detection**	Shantal Naidoo	PO Box 20449 Durban North 4016	031 303 1591 082 047 6908	operations@fireunlimited.co.za
FD2609	PROSPECT	**Stress Engineering Services cc**	**Detection**	Paul Homer	33 Stokroos Street Northmead ext 4 Benoni 1501	087 149 4246 082 577 7272	admin@sesfire.co.za
FD2507	PROSPECT	**Temoc Engineering (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Riekert Myburgh	P.O. Box 20274 Richard Bay	035 751 2759 082 876 0050	info@temoc.co.za
FD2501	PROSPECT	**Vital Intergrated Projects (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Conroy Lawrence	57 Cnr 5th Ave and Perth Road, Grassy Park Cape Town 7941	078 728 0235	conroy@vitalprojectsgroup.com
CONDITIONAL INSTALLATION COMPANIES							
FD2513	CONDITIONAL	**Ace Fire Suppression Technologies Pty) Ltd t/a Advanced Fire Suppression Technologies**	**Detection**	Werner Schilling	PO Box 14589 Alberton North 1449	011 869 2142 082 567 6443	werner@afst.co.za
FD2411	CONDITIONAL	**Advance Fire Systems cc**	**Detection**	Keith Waterson	PO Box 167219 Brackendowns 1454	011 868 3370 082 553 6642	advf@mweb.co.za
FD2410	CONDITIONAL	**Avitech Systems**	**Detection**	Eddie Bossert	P.O. Box 7719 Newton Park Port Elizabeth 6055	041 365 6534 082 467 1789	admin@avitech.co.za
FD2305	CONDITIONAL	**Cassidy Solutions**	**Detection**	Themba Mazibuko	Postnet Suite 85 Private Bag X1510 Glenvista 2058	011 496 1444 082 398 8200	thembam@cassidysolutions.co.za
FD2512	CONDITIONAL	**DSS Fire Systems (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	David Sebolai	Unit 68 Trevallyn Industrial Park CNR River Road & Hyskraan Close, Kya Sands Johannesburg	010 055 1218 060 682 4061	info@dssfire.co.za
FD2302	CONDITIONAL	**Fire Check (Pty) Ltd - Durban**	**Detection**	Nomfundo Shange	PO Box 74399, Rochdale Park Durban 4034	031 579 1340 066 473 1420	tenders@firecheck.co.za
FD047	CONDITIONAL	**FS Systems (Pty)Ltd**	**Det/Gas**	Sharl Witbooi	PO Box 142 Observatory 7925	021 685 1111 061 772 1489	sharl@fs-systems.co.za
FD2605	CONDITIONAL	**MASC Solutions (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Tim Reynolds	PO Box 16638 Doornfontein Gauteng 2028	011 100 0088 083 230 1908	timr@mascsolutions.com Doornfontein
FD2604	CONDITIONAL	**NTI Solutions (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Carly Alice Jansen	M5 Parl, Block B, Unit 18 Eastman Road, Maitland Cape Town 7405	021 741 0430 068 082 8227	info@ntisolutions.co.za
FD2407	CONDITIONAL	**Ntobe Solutions (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Lungile Nshalintshali	PO Box 12357 Nelspruit 1200	013 757 0151 082 766 2568	lungi@ntobefire.com
FD2204	CONDITIONAL	**Phakama Fire Solutions (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Lee-Anne Schlebusch	194 Main Reef Road, Newton Johannesburg 1609	010 597 7676 081 596 3301	accounts@phakama.co.za
FD2301	CONDITIONAL	**Premier Attraction 343 t/a Premier Fire Safety Engineers**	**Detection**	Vinesh Huridalay	67 Hanna Road Umbilo Durban	031 205 0548 079 411 2716	vinesh@premier-fire.co.za
FD2412	CONDITIONAL	**Sinokuthemba Fire Equipment**	**Detection**	Kelina Rantho	1725 Stevenson Street Klipfontein Emalahleni 1035	067 624 3829	sinokuthembatp@gmail.com
FD2406	CONDITIONAL	**Spero Sensors and Instruments (Pty) Ltd**	**Det/Gas**	Danie de Kock	32 Park Avenue North Rooihuiskraal Centurion 154	012 665 0317 067 096 8390	info@spero.co.za
FD1805	CONDITIONAL	**Transfire (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Rowan Ellis	PO Box 25784 East Rand 1462	011 822 2230 083 437 9746	info@transfire.co.za
INSTALLATION COMPANIES							
FD1139	INSTALLER	**ACF Technologies Pty**	**Detection**	Charles Thiongo	PO Box 2677 Edenvale	011 452 2911 082 456 9814	admin@acftech.co.za
FD2102	INSTALLER	**Ceasefire Africa (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Neil Tyler	Unit 12,15 Quark Crescent Linbro Business Park Johannesburg	010 040 2173 082 908 7251	info@ceasefire.africa.co.za
FD2307	INSTALLER	**Facility Fire (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Warren Schmidt	44 Creavity Bvd, Klipriver Business Park Cnr R59 and R550 Johannesburg	011 432 5309 082 960 0726	warren@facilityfire.co.za
FD2601	INSTALLER	**Fidelity Securefire (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Theo Van Zijl	Private Bag X5 Westgate Midrand	0860 070 700 084 680 1475	theov@fidelity-services.com
FD2202	INSTALLER	**Fire Equipment Sales & Services (Pty) Ltd t/a Fire-Quip**	**Detection**	Christiaan Mare	1 Grey Street Bloemfontein 9301	051 448 0011 073 500 8899	systems@fire-quip.co.za
FD2508	INSTALLER	**Fire Solve (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Ivan Cory	Plot 250 Vaalview Vanderbijilpark	082 958 6412 083 305 1181	admin@firesolve.co.za
FD1807	INSTALLER	**Hawk Fire Systems cc**	**Detection**	Joey Louw	PO Box 75200 Bedford Gardens Johannesburg 2047	011 028 3442 072 035 4743	hawkfire@vodamail.co.za
FG016	INSTALLER F	**ISF SFP (Pty) Ltd**	**Det/Gas**	Justin Fletcher	PO Box 82245 Southdale 2135	011 247 7800 082 774 0135	justin@isfsfp.co.za
FD076		**IBR Fire Systems (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Barry Radmore	PO Box 5119 Brenthurst 1542	011 740 2424 082 664 9133	barry@ibrfire.co.za
FD1107	INSTALLER	**Meyer Communications Africa cc**	**Detection**	Yumna Sadien	PO Box 44778 Claremont 7735	021 683 6258 082 949 5150	Yumna@meycom.co.za
FD024	INSTALLER	**Multi-Net Systems (Pty)Ltd**	**Det/Gas**	Johan Smith	PO Box 48561 Hercules 0030	012 379 1753 083 458 8970	tenders@multinetsystems.co.za
FD2001	INSTALLER	**OPT-X Project Management Services (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Kerry Rafferty	PO Box 12056 Monte Vista 7460	021 558 7557 083 305 2584	leonie@opt-x.co.za
FD009	INSTALLER	**Sensor Special Risk Technologies**	**Det/Gas**	Clive Foord	PO Box 2005 Primrose 1416	011 452 1339 082 446 1475	ssr@sensor.co.za
FFD2405	INSTALLER	**Southern Cross Fire & Security (Pty Ltd**	**Detection**	Mario Groenewald	Unit 10, 13 Pasita Street Rosenpark, Belville Cape Town 7530	021 981 5470 064 682 2350	info@southerncrossfire.co.za
FD1805A	INSTALLER	**Transfire Eastern Cape (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Raymond Nel	11 Bellgrove Street Port Elizabeth	041 484 1408 082 929 7801	raymond.cape@transfire.co.za
FD2009	INSTALLER	**SSC Infrasek (Pty) Ltd**	**Detrction**	AJ Robinson	P.O. Box 1132 Sanlamhof 7530	021 949 9000 082 773 3865	info@ssc1.co.za
FD1903	INSTALLER	**Stefmet Technologies**	**Detection**	Dewald Janse Van Vuuren	PO Box 48950 Pretoria 30	012 377 2454 083 709 3344	dewald@stefmet.co.za
FD2404	INSTALLER	**Unique Fire (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Nico de Plessis	PO Box 2797 Polokwane 700	073 293 0405	nico@uniquefire.co.za
FD1604	INSTALLER	**Wideband Electronic Services cc**	**Detection**	Casey Lage	PO Box 101 Bassonia 2081	011 432 1215 083 468 6003	casey@wideband.co.za
SUPPLIER MEMBERS							
FD2511	SUPPLIER	**Compass Visual Security (Pty) Ltd**	**Det/Gas**	Cedric Greeves	8 Kathleen Close Oak Park Pietermaritzburg 3201	031 701 1060 082 898 3856	info@compasssecurity.co.za
FD041	SUPPLIER	**Fire and Security Techniques (Pty Ltd**	**Gas**	Hanlie Truter	PO Box 277 Raslouw 0109	012 621 9400 083 309 8528	htruter@fstafrica.co.za
FD2002	SUPPLIER	**Kidde Fire and Security South Africa (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Robert Sibbett	29 Angus Cresent Edenvale 1609	011 579-7300 082 415 0504	rob.sibbbett@kgsolutions.com
FD2201	SUPPLIER	**QD Detection and Suppression Pty) Ltd**	**Det/Gas**	Warren Dowse	PO Box 1993 Northriding 2162	011 251 9300 082 578 6446	wdowse@qd.co.za
FD2008	SUPPLIER	**Red G Distributors**	**Gas**	Dean Swart	Postnet Suite 260 Private X18 Northriding 2162	011 708 0160 082 578 7133	dean@redg.co.za
FD2614	SUPPLIER	**Regent Imports (Pty) Ltd t/a Regent Fire**	**Detection**	Hylton Turner	P.O. Box 1991 Kelvin ohannesburg 2054	011 574 7606 072 991 5179	hylton.turner@regentfire.co.za
FD125	SUPPLIER	**Technoswitch (Pty) Ltd**	**Detection**	Hendrik Cloete	PO Box 1752 Randpark Ridge 2156	011 794 9144 074 871 1861	hendrik@technoswitch.co.za
O.E.M SUPPLIER							
FD2606	O.E.M SUPPLIER	**Ajax Systems Trading FZE**	**Detection**	Preston Maharaj	FZJOB0710 Jebel Ali, Freezone Dubai United Arab Emirates	078 500 1155	maharaj.p@ajax.systems
FD2608	O.E.M SUPPLIER	**Johnson Controls, Fire Supression Solutions**	**Detection**	Corne Momberg	Suite 1704 API World Tower, Sheikh Zayed Road Dubai United Arab Emirates	060 546 8888	corne.momberg@jci.com
FD2611	O.E.M SUPPLIER	**Securiton AG**	**Detection**	Steven Freudiger	Alpenstrasse 20 Zollikofen Switzerland	083 452 4618	steven.freudiger@securiton.co.za
CONSULTANTS							
FD1901	CONSULTANT	**Diversified Security Engineering**	**Consultant**	Nigel Versfeld	30 Harries Street Plumstead Cape Town 7800	082 460 7723	nigelv@dsegroup.co.za
FD2309	CONSULTANT	**Proconics (Pty) Ltd**	**Consultant**	Francisco De Freitas	PO Box 3291 Secunda 2302	073 150 0431	mail@proconics.co.za
ASSOCIATE MEMBERS							
FD011	ASSOCIATE	**Sysman Public Safety Systems (Pty) Ltd**	**Associate**	Richard McLaughlin	Postnet Suite 022 Private Bag X153 Bryanston 2021	011 300 3300 083 602 5722	richard@sysman.co.za
FE001	ASSOCIATE	**TOA Electronics Southern Africa (Pty) Ltd**	**Associate**	Michelle Engelbrecht	Postnet Suite 106 Private BagX1 Edenglen 1613	011 608 1477 083 380 6026	mengelbrecht@toasa.co.za
FD1009	ASSOCIATE	**West Coast Automation Systems cc**	**Associate**	Elzane de Bruin	PO Box 1388 Oranjemund Namibia	081 201 4917	info@westcoastas.com

Fire Protection Association of Southern Africa

Since 1973 .....

The Association has offered an array of fire risk management, consulting and engineering services. These include fire risk assessments, legal compliance reviews, fire safety audits, fire investigations, fire and evacuation procedures and plans; along with general fire safety management consulting.

A wide range of courses is presented by the FPA Fire College. Among these are the Confederation of Fire Protection Associations (Europe) Diploma in Fire Prevention and the CFPA Europe Principles of Fire Engineering course.

FPASA's Insurer Fire Impact Reduction Strategy (InFIReS) incorporates The National Fire Information Resource (NatFIRe) facility to improve the collection, collation and availability of National Fire Loss Statistics.

The membership options and benefits add value to any organisation with an interest in fire engineering, fire prevention, fire protection, or fire safety management.



FPASA
P O Box 15467 Impala Park 1472
Website: www.fpasa.co.za
Tel: (011) 397 1618

FIRE PROTECTION ASSOCIATION OF SOUTHERN AFRICA

(Incorporated Association not for Gain.Reg. No. 1973/000022/08)